Beyond the Million-Dollar Flat: Understanding Singapore's HDB Resale Price Transformation (2017–2025)

Introduction and Objective

In recent years, Singapore's HDB resale market has attracted considerable attention as more million-dollar transactions make the headlines. Today, platforms such as 99.co and EdgeProp regularly report new records (David, 2026; Mokhtar, 2025). This raises a simple question: are resale prices changing across the board?

Looking only at million-dollar flats may not give an accurate picture, because flats differ significantly in location, flat type and age. Using HDB's official resale data, this project examines whether the rise in million-dollar transactions reflects broader price growth, or whether these high-value transactions remain concentrated within particular housing segments.

1. The Dataset

1.1 Observations and variables

The dataset comes from HDB's official resale transaction records on data.gov.sg and contains 242,454 observations across 11 variables. We restricted the period to January 2017 to December 2025, leaving 222,066 observations across 26 towns and seven flat types. No missing values were found across the original variables.

1.2 Variable types

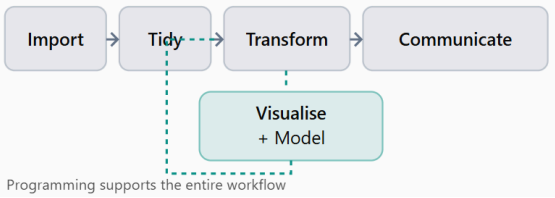


Figure1:Data analysis workflow

The original variables used in our analysis are month (character, converted to date), town, flat type and storey range (categorical), and floor area, lease commencement date and resale price (numeric). Using mutate() and case_when(), we created transaction year and quarter, flat age, estimated storey midpoint, floor categories, price per square metre (PSM) and a binary indicator identifying million-dollar transactions.

2. Summary Statistics

	transactions	mean_price	median_price	sd_price	min_price	max_price
1	222066	524464	492000	186594	140000	1658888

Figure2:Summary statistics of HDB resale prices, 2017–2025.

Using group_by() and summarise(), we evaluated monthly, annual and town-level trends. Across the dataset, resale prices recorded a mean of S$524,464, median of S$492,000, minimum of S$140,000 and maximum of S$1,658,888. The mean being higher than the median suggests a positively skewed distribution, where higher-priced transactions pull the average upwards.

3. Findings and Analysis (Visualisations)

Visualisations were developed using ggplot2, including line charts and a geographical price heatmap, to examine changes in transaction shares, prices over time and geographical differences.

3.1. Growth of Million-Dollar HDB Transactions

Million-dollar transactions made up less than 1% of resales in 2020 but over 6% by 2025. They are becoming more common, yet remain a small share of the market, so their growth alone does not mean the typical flat is approaching the same price. However, broader

price changes are also evident: the share of transactions below S$500,000 fell from 73% in 2017 to 23% in 2025, showing that price increases extended beyond million-dollar flats.

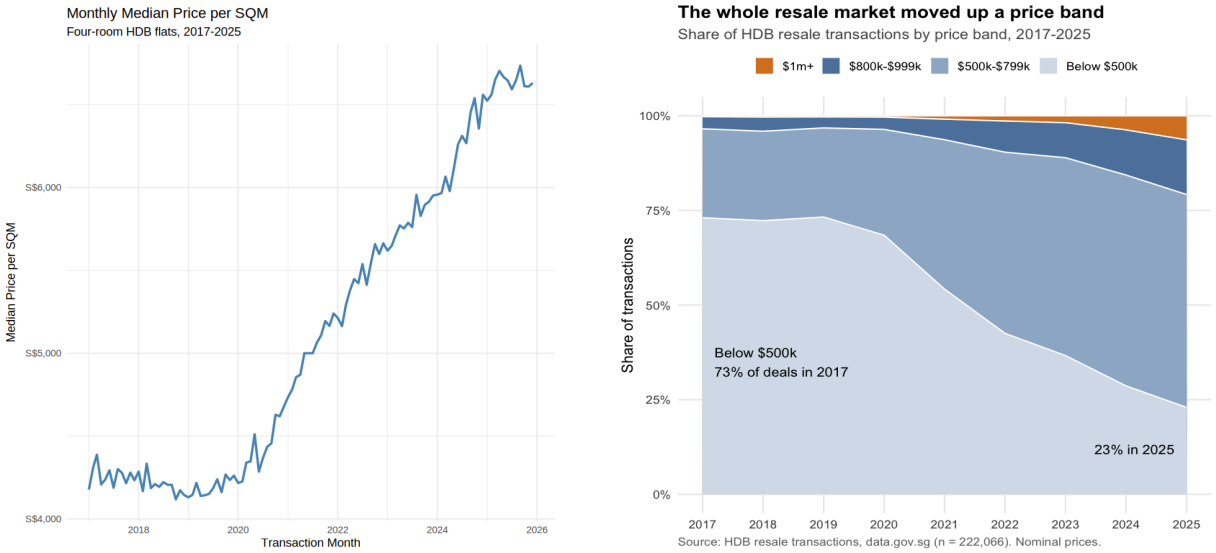


Figure3-4: Shifts in resale price distribution(left) and Growth in million-dollar transactions (right), 2017–2025.

3.2. Historical Resale Price Trends

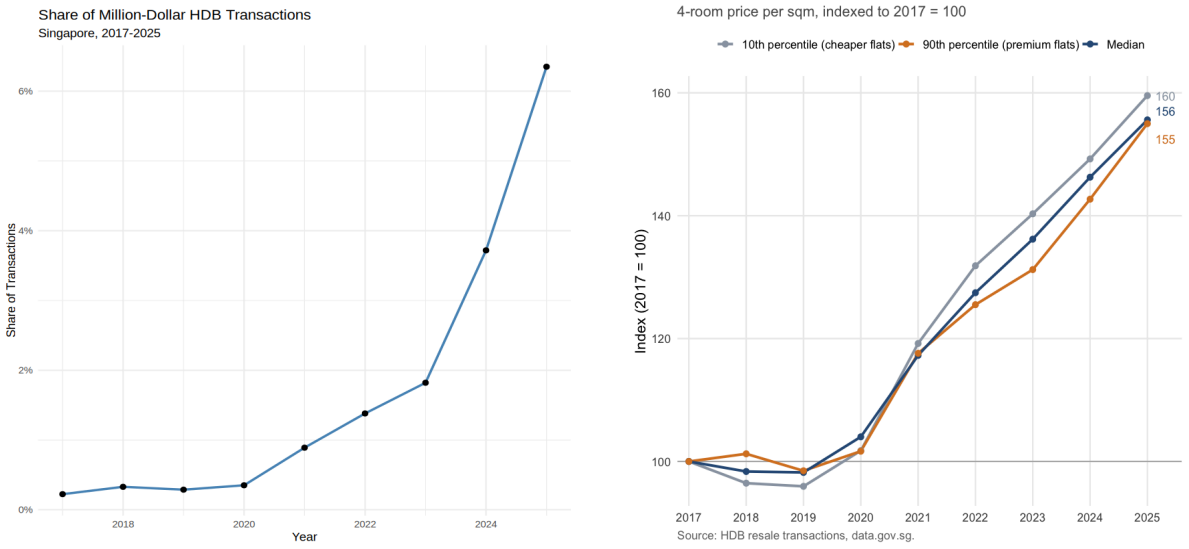


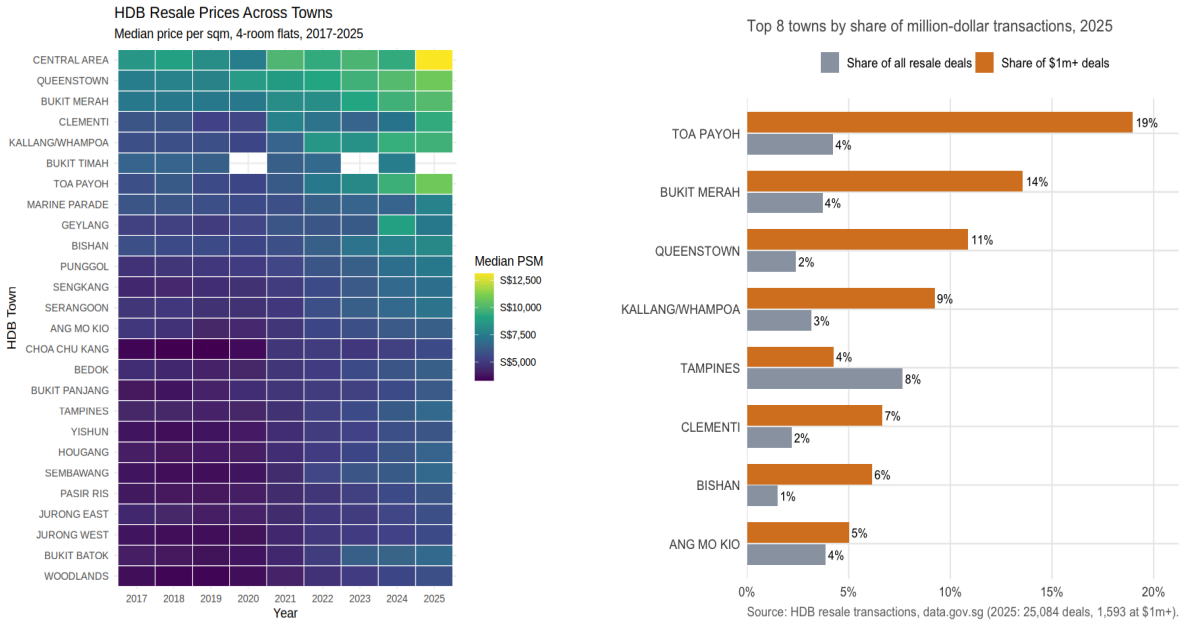
Figure5-6: Price percentiles (left) for four-room HDB flats and Monthly median PSM (right) 2017–2025.

To examine whether price growth extends beyond premium flats, we analysed median PSM for four-room flats, allowing more consistent comparisons across transactions. Based on the monthly trend visualisation, median PSM remained relatively stable between 2017 and 2019, before rising more sharply from 2020 onwards.

In 2025, a total of 10,843 four-room resale transactions were recorded, with a median PSM of about $6,634 and a mean of $7,121. The higher mean suggests that higher-priced transactions pull the average upwards. Over time, price growth was evident across the distribution, with slightly stronger increases at the lower end.

Our results also follow HDB's official Resale Price Index (RPI), which rose approximately 52% between 2017 and 2025, compared with 53% for our overall median resale price and 56% for four-room median PSM. Their similar trends strengthen confidence in our findings. However, after adjusting for inflation using Singapore's Consumer Price Index, median resale prices increased approximately 29%, rather than 53%. This suggests that part of the nominal price increase reflects general inflation.

3.3. Geographical Variations Across Towns



Figures 7-8: Town-level median PSM (left) and million-dollar transaction shares (right).

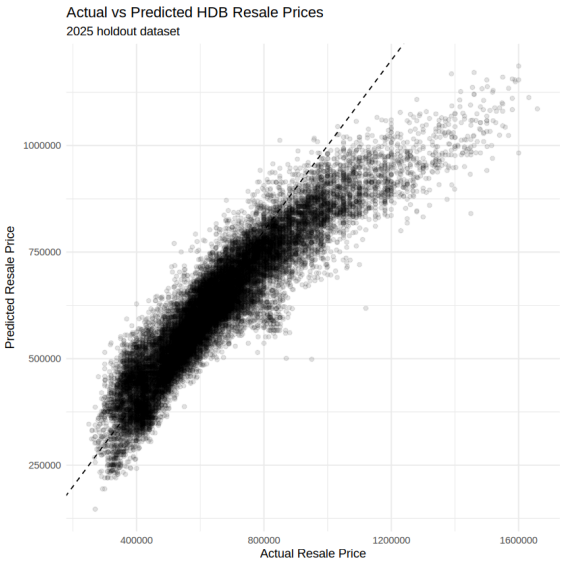
The heatmap compares the median PSM of four-room flats across towns from 2017 to 2025, while the bar chart compares each town's share of million-dollar and overall resale transactions in 2025.

Two patterns stand out in the heatmap. Central Area, Queenstown and Bukit Merah consistently recorded the highest median PSM, while Woodlands, Jurong West and Choa Chu Kang remained among the lowest. Prices also rose across almost every town after 2020, including traditionally more affordable areas.

However, the bar chart shows that million-dollar transactions remained concentrated: five towns accounted for approximately 59% of such sales in 2025, despite representing only 16% of all resale transactions. Together, the charts show that widespread price growth and the concentration of the highest-priced sales can coexist.

4. Models: Understanding Factors Influencing Resale Prices

Model 1, a multiple linear regression, examines how resale prices relate to floor area, flat age, storey midpoint, town, flat type and transaction year, while controlling for the other included characteristics.



flat_type	transactions	MAE
<chr>	<int>	<dbl>
MULTI-GENERATION	4	160492.54
EXECUTIVE	1470	106392.91
5 ROOM	5781	74084.70
4 ROOM	10843	60539.57
3 ROOM	6149	52816.96
1 ROOM	5	51794.44
2 ROOM	832	44513.10

Figure 9-10: Actual vs. predicted resale prices (left); transactions and MAE by flat type (right), 2025.

Model 1 achieved an R^2 of about 0.845, meaning the selected variables explain around 85% of the variation in resale prices in the sample used to calculate this statistic. Larger floor areas and higher storeys were associated with higher prices, while older flats were associated

with lower prices, after accounting for the other variables. When tested against 2025 transactions, the model produced an MAE of about $63,938, suggesting that factors not captured in the dataset also influence individual prices. Therefore, the results indicate statistical associations, not causal relationships, and predictions remain subject to error.

Model 2 forecasts monthly four-room median PSM, comparing a time-trend and seasonality regression, an ARIMA model and a seasonal-naive benchmark, using training data through 2024 and reserving 2025 for testing. Within Model 2, the simple trend and seasonality regression performed best, with an MAE of about $286 per sqm, compared with $298 for ARIMA and $396 for the seasonal-naive benchmark. A more complex model therefore did not produce more accurate predictions.

Conclusion

The analysis suggests that the rise in million-dollar HDB transactions is part of a broader trend of resale price growth, rather than an isolated phenomenon. However, substantial differences remain across flat types and locations, and million-dollar flats still make up only a small share of the market.

From a communications perspective, reporting transaction shares alongside typical prices and differences between housing segments provides a more balanced picture than focusing on exceptional million-dollar sales alone.

(Word count: 989)

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Appendix (Supplementary Analysis & External Validation)

1. Situation and Objective

The Housing & Development Board (HDB) has long played a critical role in providing accessible housing to Singaporeans. However, with the growing number of million-dollar resale transactions in recent years, the question of whether public housing remains affordable has once again come under scrutiny. While million-dollar flats are often associated with desirable locations, larger floor areas and premium attributes, there is a concern that these exceptional prices may gradually influence expectations across the wider resale market.

This supplementary analysis extends our main findings by examining affordability, policy developments and how million-dollar transactions are communicated to the public.

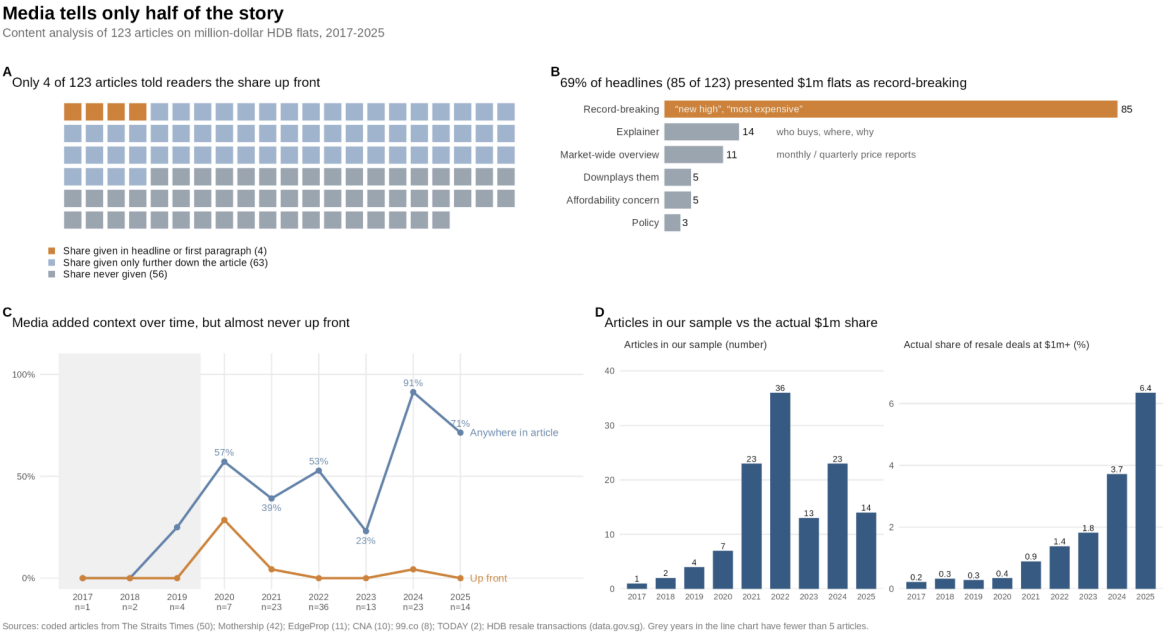


Figure 1: Media framing and presentation of million-dollar transaction shares, 2017–2025.

Our preliminary media content analysis of 123 articles published between 2017 and 2025 found that 85 (69%) used record-focused headlines, highlighting new highs, firsts or

exceptionally expensive sales. Only four articles included the share of million-dollar transactions in the headline or first paragraph. Another 63 provided this context later in the article, while 56 did not mention it. Although the proportion providing context varied across years, it was rarely presented upfront. This suggests that readers may encounter record-breaking transaction counts without immediately seeing how common these sales are in the wider resale market.

Our findings suggest that the rise in million-dollar transactions is part of broader resale price growth, although high-value transactions remain concentrated in certain towns. The following analyses further examine these trends through inflation-adjusted prices, household income and supplementary modelling.

2. Market Analysis : Understanding Price Changes

2.1 Comparing Our Results Against the Official HDB Resale Price Index

To assess the reliability of the historical price trends, our results were compared with HDB's official Resale Price Index (RPI). Using quarterly RPI values aggregated into annual averages, the figures were re-indexed to 2017 = 100 for comparison with our median resale prices and four-room median PSM.

The official RPI increased by approximately 52% between 2017 and 2025, compared with 53% for our overall median resale price and 56% for four-room median PSM. While the three measures are not methodologically identical, their relatively similar trajectories provide additional confidence that the broader upward trend is not merely the result of changes in the composition of flats transacted.

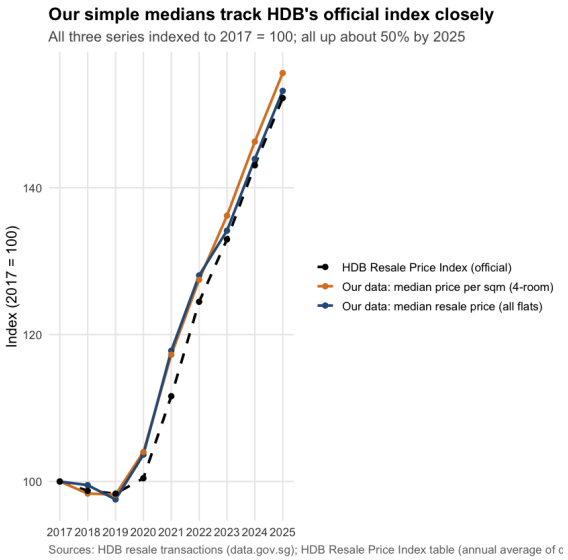


Figure 2: HDB RPI and median resale price indices, 2017–2025.

2.2 Exploring Housing Affordability Through Household Income

To provide additional context, median resale prices were compared with median annual household income, calculated using historical SingStat household income figures from 2017 to 2024. The price-to-income ratio increased from approximately 3.8 years in 2017 to 4.4 years in 2024. For a fixed S$1 million flat, the ratio decreased from approximately 9.2 to 7.4 years as household income increased.

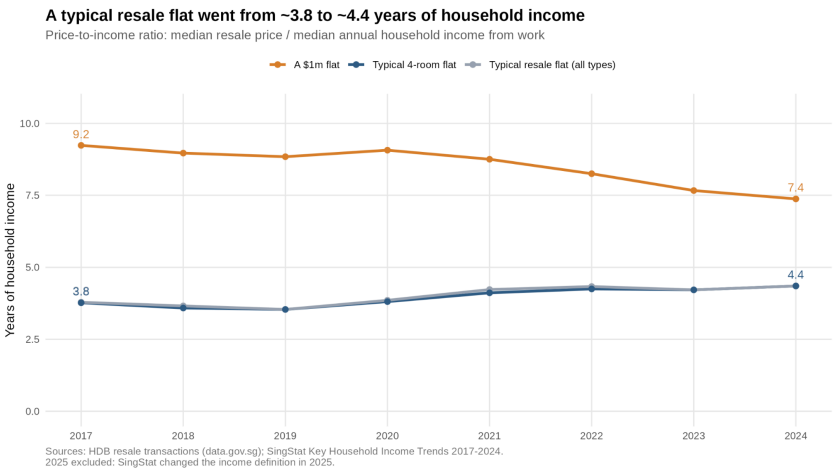


Figure 3: Price-to-income ratios for typical and S$1m flats, 2017–2024.

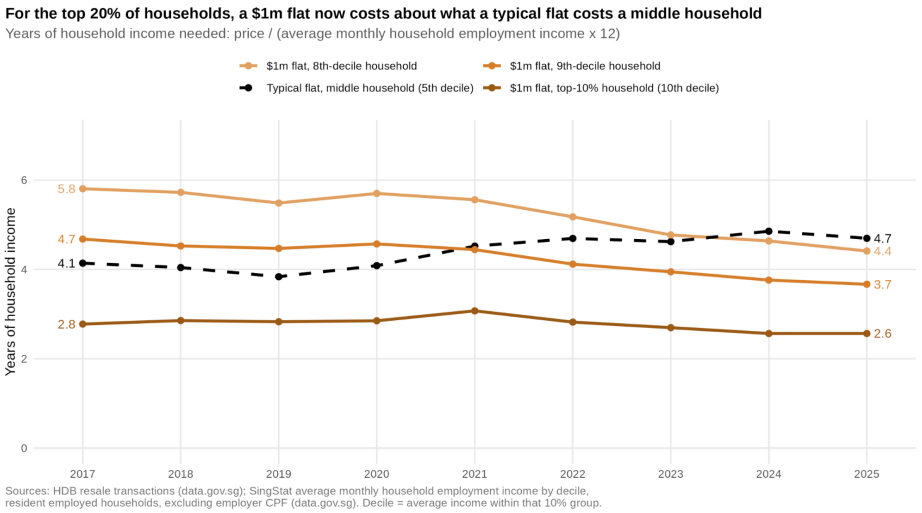


Figure 4: Price-to-income ratios across household income groups, 2017–2025.

However, this should be treated as an indicative comparison rather than a definitive affordability assessment. The analysis does not account for actual buyer incomes, CPF housing grants, borrowing arrangements or mortgage servicing costs. Furthermore, the series ends in 2024 to avoid combining household-income figures derived using different statistical definitions.

2.3 Integrating CPI to Account for Inflation

To account for changes in purchasing power, Singapore's annual Consumer Price Index (CPI) was incorporated using left_join(), allowing resale prices to be expressed in constant 2025 dollars. Based on the analysis, median resale prices increased approximately 53% nominally between 2017 and 2025. However, after adjusting for general inflation, the increase was approximately 29%.

We also compared million-dollar transaction shares using a fixed real threshold of S$1 million in 2025 purchasing power. Under this definition, the proportion increased from approximately 2.1% in 2017 to 6.4% in 2025. This is a smaller increase than under the unadjusted nominal threshold. The results suggest that general inflation and the fixed nominal

threshold are important considerations when interpreting the apparent growth of million-dollar transactions. Nevertheless, this does not imply that the increase can be attributed to inflation alone.

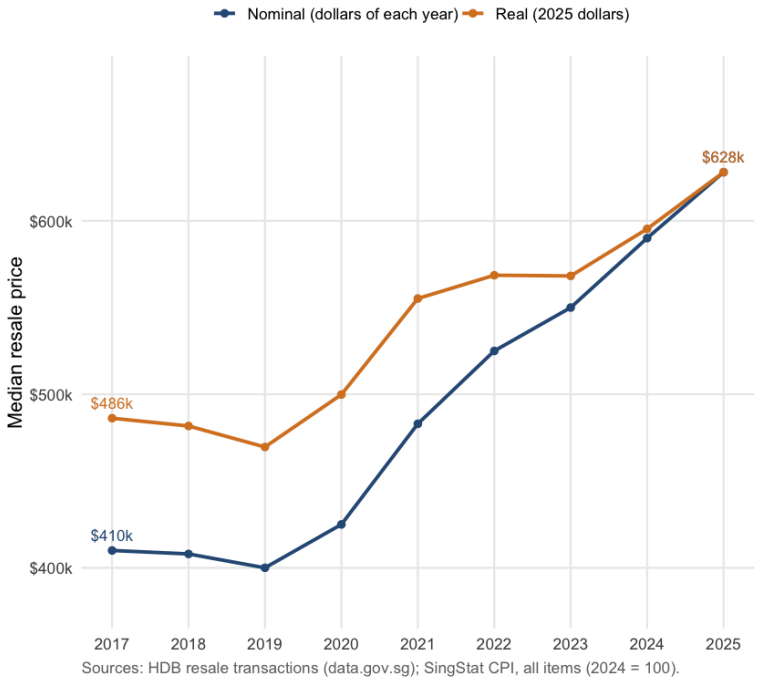


Figure 5: Nominal and inflation-adjusted median resale prices, 2017–2025.

2.4 Counterfactual Simulation of the Million-Dollar Threshold

To further investigate the threshold hypothesis, the group developed a simplified counterfactual simulation using purrr::map_dbl(). The simulation retains the distribution of flats sold in 2017, while applying each subsequent year's observed median price growth uniformly to those original transaction prices.

Under this scenario, approximately 10.5% of the simulated transactions would exceed S$1 million by 2025, compared with the actual recorded share of 6.4%. This suggests that broad-based price appreciation is mathematically capable of generating a substantial increase in million-dollar transactions, even without disproportionately higher appreciation among premium properties.

However, the exercise holds the 2017 transaction mix constant. As the composition of flats sold changes over time, the simulation should be viewed as an illustrative sensitivity analysis rather than a causal estimate of what drove actual transactions.

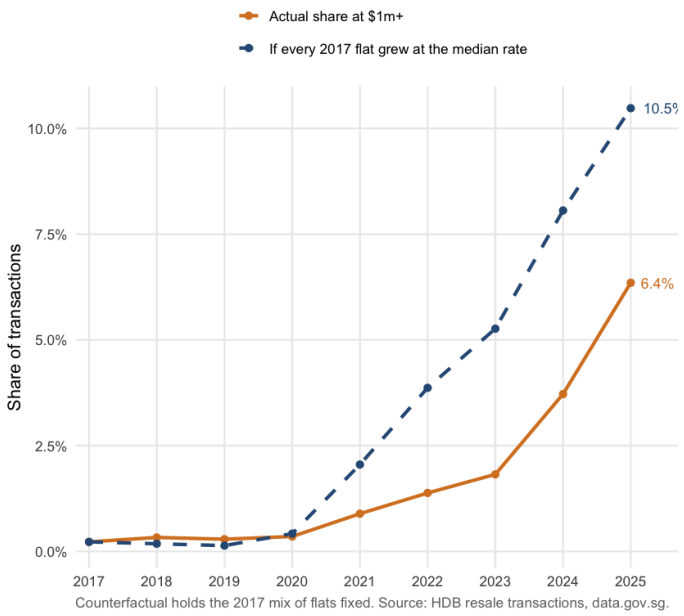
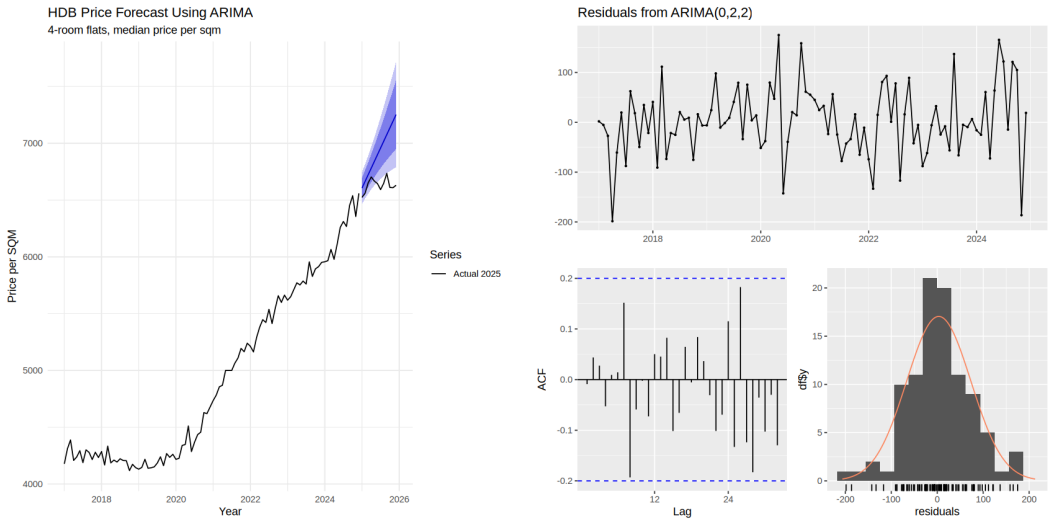


Figure 6: Actual vs. counterfactual million-dollar transaction shares, 2017–2025.

2.5 Time-Series Forecasting and Model Comparison

We evaluated forecasts of monthly median PSM for four-room flats using three approaches: a simple time-trend and seasonality regression model, an ARIMA model and a seasonal-naïve benchmark. For consistency, the models were trained using historical observations through 2024 and evaluated against actual 2025 prices.

The simpler regression model achieved the lowest MAE of approximately $286 per sqm, compared with $298 for ARIMA and $396 for the seasonal-naïve benchmark. As the forecasting models were evaluated using a single holdout year, the results provide an initial indication of predictive performance, but further validation across multiple time periods would be necessary before relying on the models for longer-term forecasting.



Model	MAE	RMSE
<chr>	<dbl>	<dbl>
1 ARIMA	298.	355.
2 Seasonal Naive	396.	445.

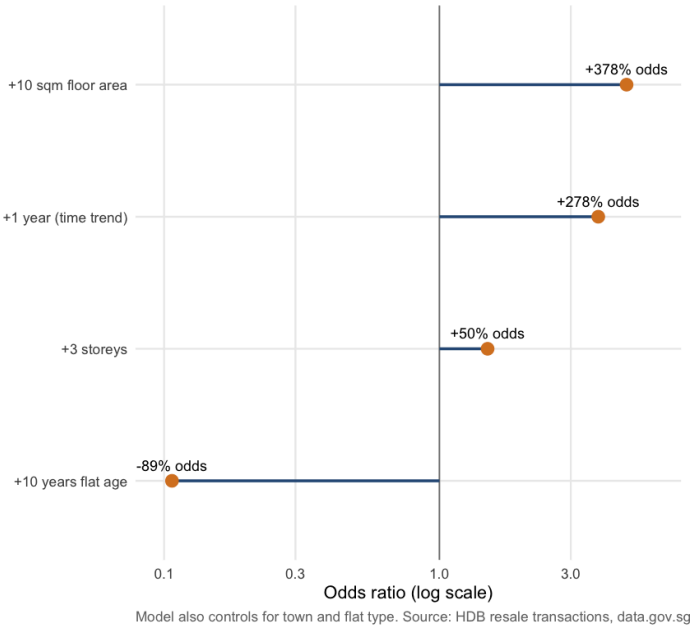
Figure 7: ARIMA forecasting, residual diagnostics and model comparison.

2.6 Additional Model Validation

A logistic regression model was also developed to examine the likelihood of a transaction reaching S$1 million. The model used floor area, flat age, storey midpoint, town, flat type and transaction year as explanatory variables, with 2025 transactions reserved for evaluation.

The model achieved a Brier score of approximately 0.0226, compared with 0.0621 for a simple baseline, and an AUC of approximately 0.985.

Although these indicate relatively strong performance on the selected test period, the model generated warnings associated with fitted probabilities approaching zero or one. This may reflect sparse categories and quasi-separation, potentially affecting the stability of individual coefficients and odds ratios. Further model refinement would therefore be needed before interpreting the estimated effects or applying the model to future transactions.



change	odds_ratio	interpretation
<chr>	<dbl>	<chr>
+10 sqm floor area	4.7841629	+378% odds
+10 years flat age	0.1068107	-89% odds
+3 storeys	1.4963319	+50% odds
+1 year (time trend)	3.7757326	+278% odds

A tibble: 2 x 3

model	brier	auc
<chr>	<dbl>	<dbl>
Naive baseline (training average)	0.06211016	0.5000000
Logistic regression	0.02263483	0.9849445

A tibble: 1 x 2

actual_2025_million	predicted_2025_million
<dbl>	<dbl>
1593	1450.303

Figure 8: Logistic regression odds ratios and model evaluation.

3. What the Results Suggest

Taken together, our findings suggest that the rise in million-dollar transactions is part of broader resale price growth, although high-value transactions remain concentrated in certain towns. Inflation and the fixed S$1 million threshold also affect how this increase is interpreted. However, the number of million-dollar transactions alone does not provide a complete picture of housing affordability. These differences are important when assessing existing housing policies and communicating market trends to the public.

3.1 Assessment and Evaluation

The preceding analyses show that resale price growth extends beyond million-dollar flats, while differences across towns and housing segments remain. These findings provide a basis for considering how existing housing measures address broader market pressures and affordability concerns.

Looking beyond the dataset, the Government has already introduced several cooling and affordability measures. In August 2024, the Loan-to-Value limit for HDB housing loans was reduced from 80% to 75%, while the Enhanced CPF Housing Grant was increased to support eligible first-time buyers (HDB, 2024a), although median resale prices continued to rise over the study period.

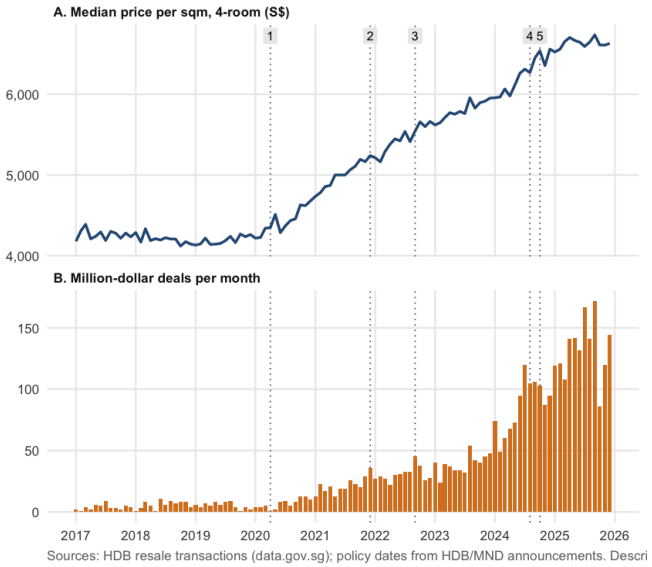


Figure 9: Median PSM and million-dollar transactions, 2017–2025.

Additionally, the Standard, Plus and Prime classification framework introduced tighter resale restrictions and subsidy recovery for more desirable new flats (HDB, 2024b).

More recent developments also warrant consideration. HDB's Resale Price Index recorded three consecutive quarterly declines during the first three quarters of 2026 (HDB, 2026c). This suggests that market conditions are showing signs of moderation, although it would be premature to attribute the changes entirely to cooling measures without further analysis.

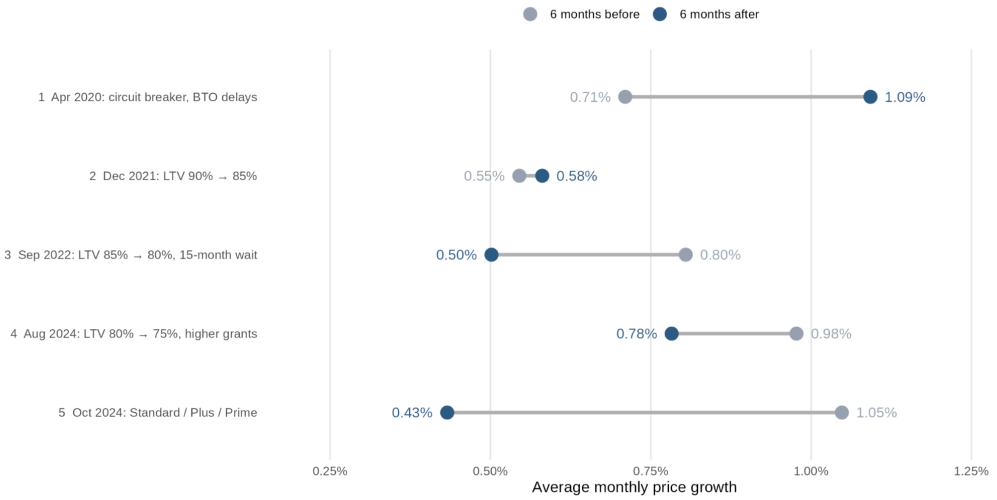


FIgure 10: Average Monthly Price Growth Before and After Selected Policy Announcements

We compared average monthly price growth during the six months before and after each policy announcement. The results show that price growth accelerated after 2020. Growth slowed following some policy announcements, but not consistently across all events. These comparisons describe changes in market trends rather than proving that the measures caused them. Growth here is defined as the month-on-month change in the 4-room median price per sqm.

These measures address different aspects of the housing market, including borrowing conditions, support for first-time buyers and resale restrictions. However, our analysis does not establish the effects of individual policies. Given the broader price growth and differences across towns, it remains important to consider both overall market conditions and the needs of different housing segments when evaluating policy responses.

3.2 Further Implications for Public Communication

Our additional analysis found continued high monthly volumes of million-dollar transactions, even as HDB's official RPI began to moderate. This supports the need to

communicate transaction counts alongside the proportion of overall resale activity, median prices and differences between housing segments.

Although our preliminary media analysis identified differences in how transaction counts and proportions were presented, the findings should not be generalised to all media coverage without a clearly documented sampling and coding process.

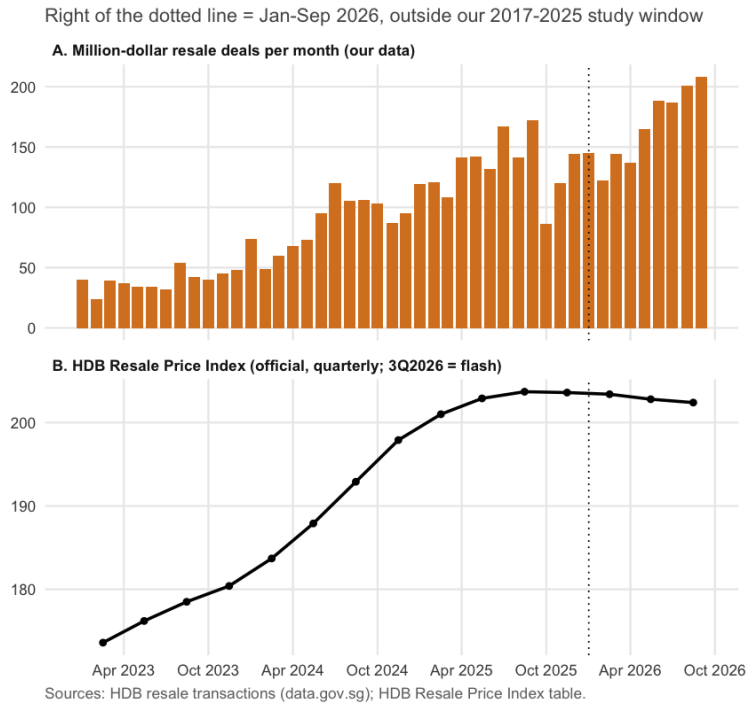


Figure 11: Monthly million-dollar HDB transactions and quarterly Resale Price Index, 2023–2026.

3.3 Key Recommendations

Assuming the role of HDB, our recommendations can be divided into three key phases.

3.3.1 Short-Term: Improve Transparency and Public Communication

Rather than focusing primarily on headline average prices, HDB could publish accessible comparisons showing median and percentile-based resale prices across towns, flat types and remaining lease periods. This could be accompanied by practical illustrations of

affordability based on household income, available housing grants and estimated monthly mortgage commitments.

3.3.2 Medium-Term: Monitor Price Pressures and Support Genuine Buyers

By tracking town-level price movements alongside transaction volumes, flat ages and upcoming housing supply, HDB could identify areas experiencing sustained appreciation that may warrant further investigation. Rather than introducing blanket cooling measures, there is an opportunity to assess whether additional assistance should be targeted towards households facing genuine accessibility constraints.

However, any expansion of buyer grants should be carefully evaluated, as additional purchasing power could also translate into higher resale prices if housing supply remains constrained.

3.3.3 Long-Term: Strengthen Supply Planning and Housing Accessibility

HDB has already committed to launching approximately 55,000 BTO flats from 2025 to 2027, including more flats with shorter waiting times (HDB, 2026a). We propose further strengthening this approach through transparent demand forecasts, monitoring of flats reaching their Minimum Occupation Period and continued evaluation of supply distribution across different towns. For households with more urgent housing needs, an assessment of interim housing options could also reduce the pressure to enter the resale market prematurely.

4. Limitations

Firstly, the dataset only covers completed resale transactions, so changes in the types and locations of flats sold may influence price trends.

Secondly, although we conducted supplementary inflation-adjusted and household-income comparisons, these do not account for actual buyer incomes, housing

grants, borrowing arrangements or mortgage servicing costs. This limits our ability to draw firm conclusions about housing affordability.

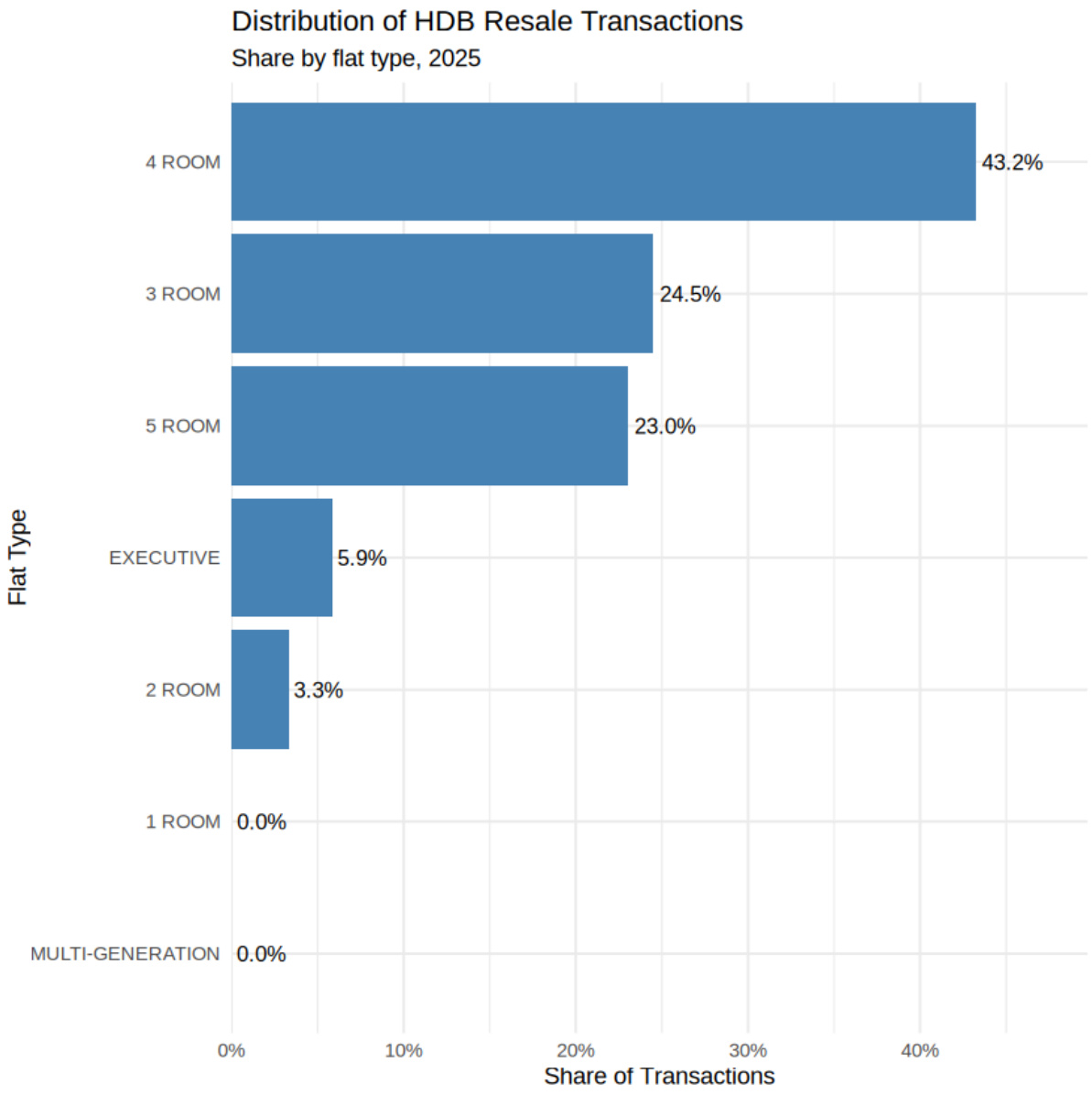
Thirdly, the regression model did not include factors such as proximity to amenities and transport, renovation quality and individual unit conditions.

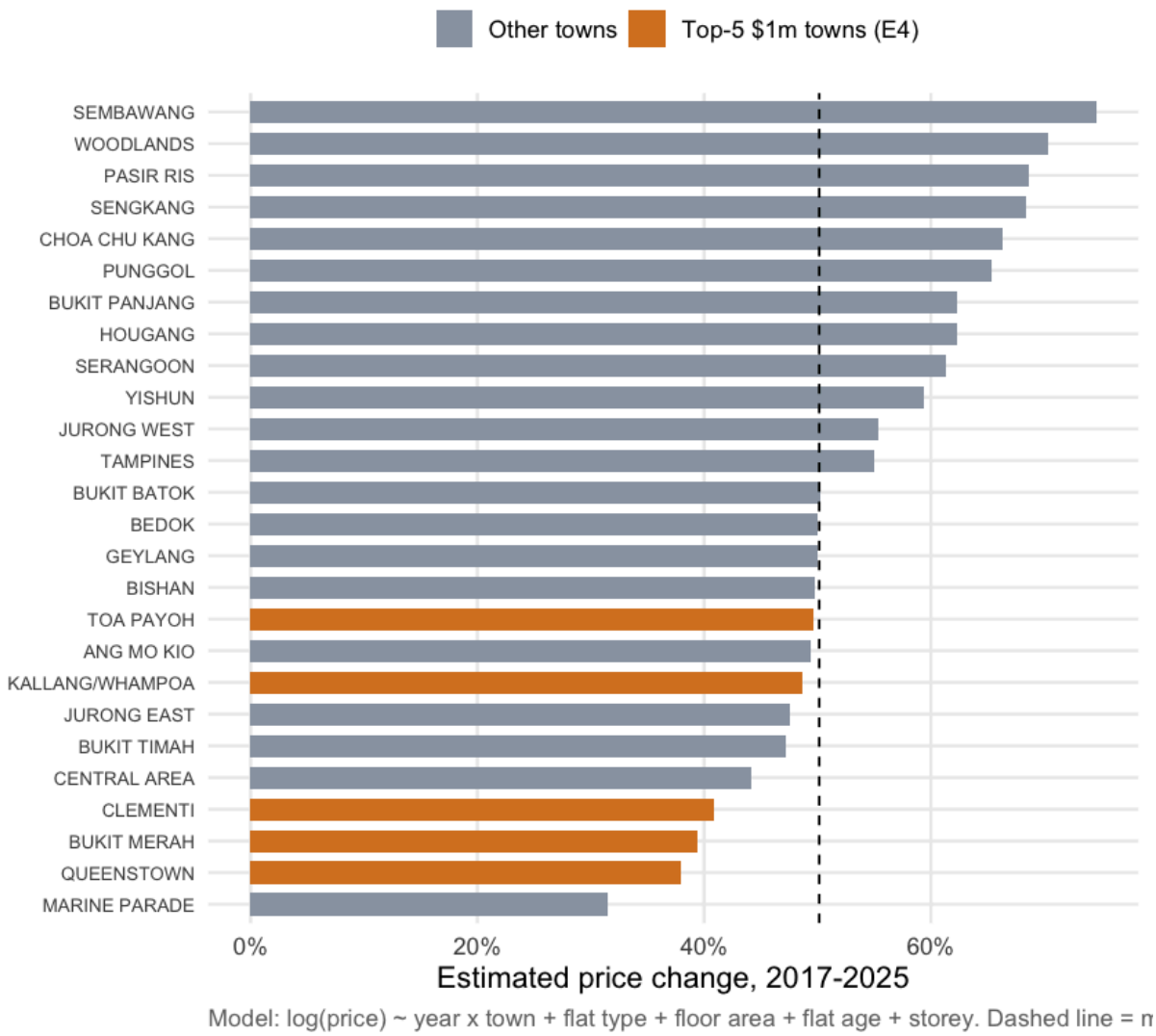
5. Summary of Our Findings

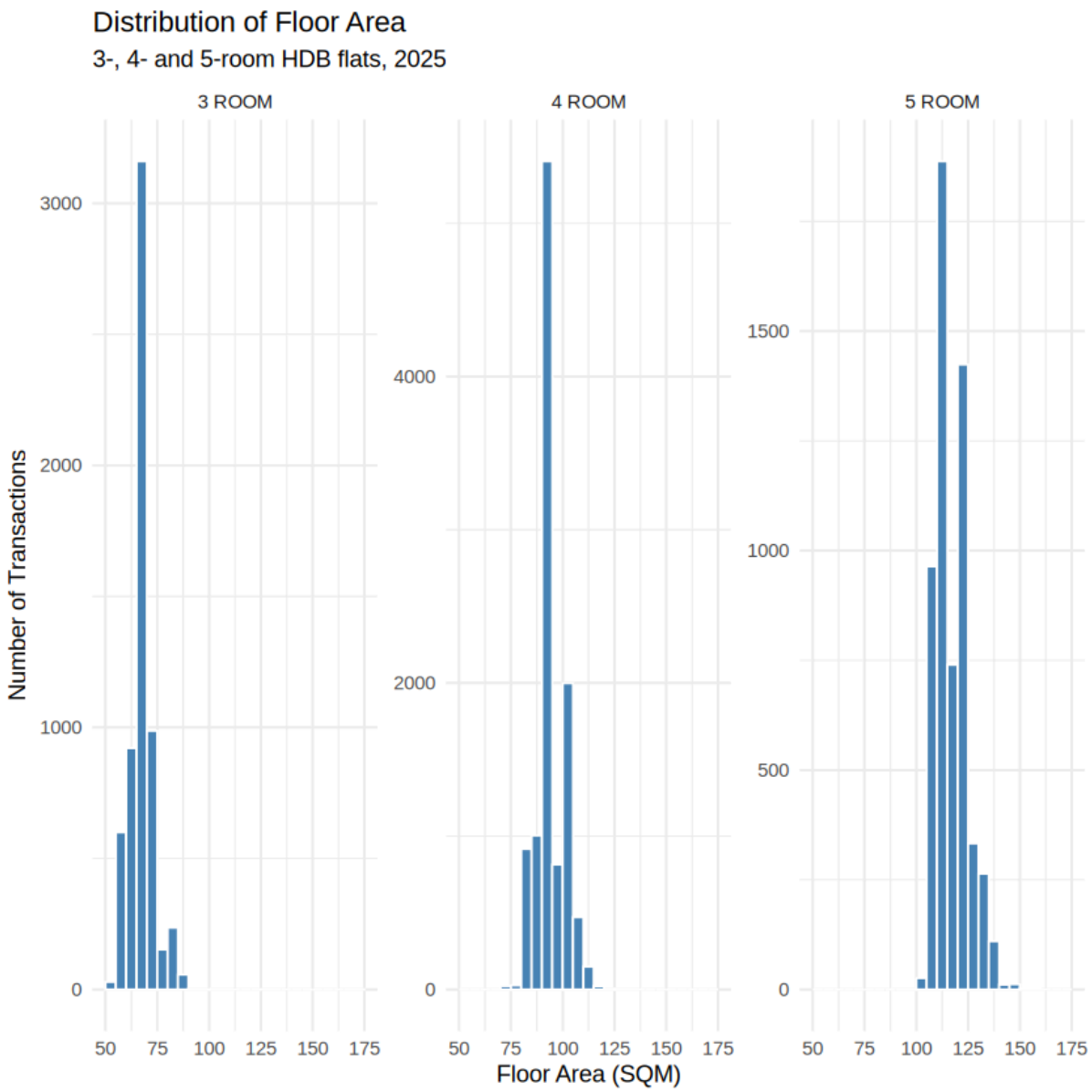
The findings suggest that the million-dollar HDB phenomenon is only one part of a larger story of rising resale prices and persistent geographical differences. While recent policy measures and signs of moderation are encouraging, the longer-term challenge is maintaining a balance between the asset value of existing homeowners and accessibility for future buyers.

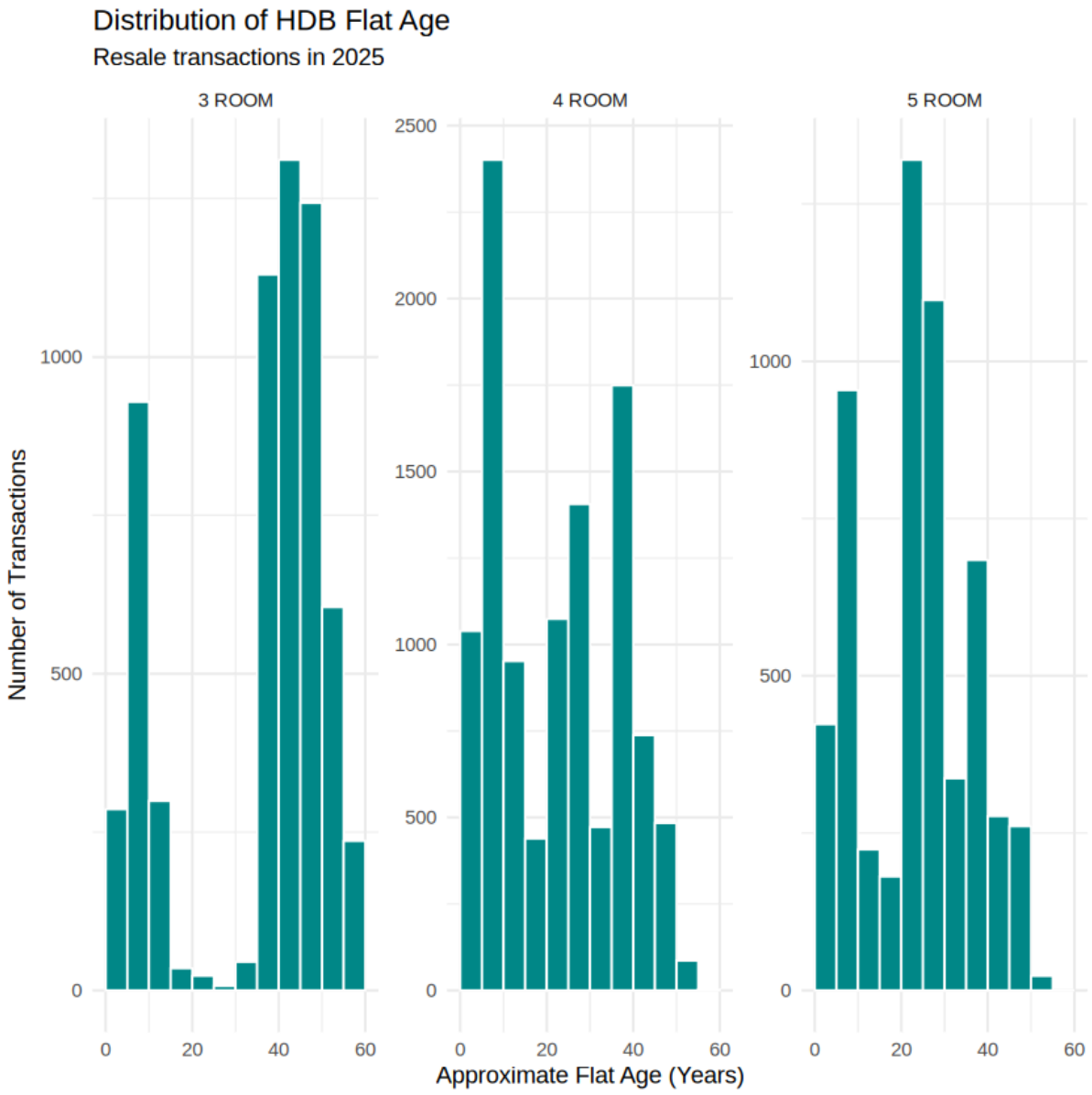
Ultimately, the objective should not be to eliminate million-dollar flats, but to ensure that exceptional resale prices do not become the benchmark by which ordinary Singaporeans judge their ability to own a home.

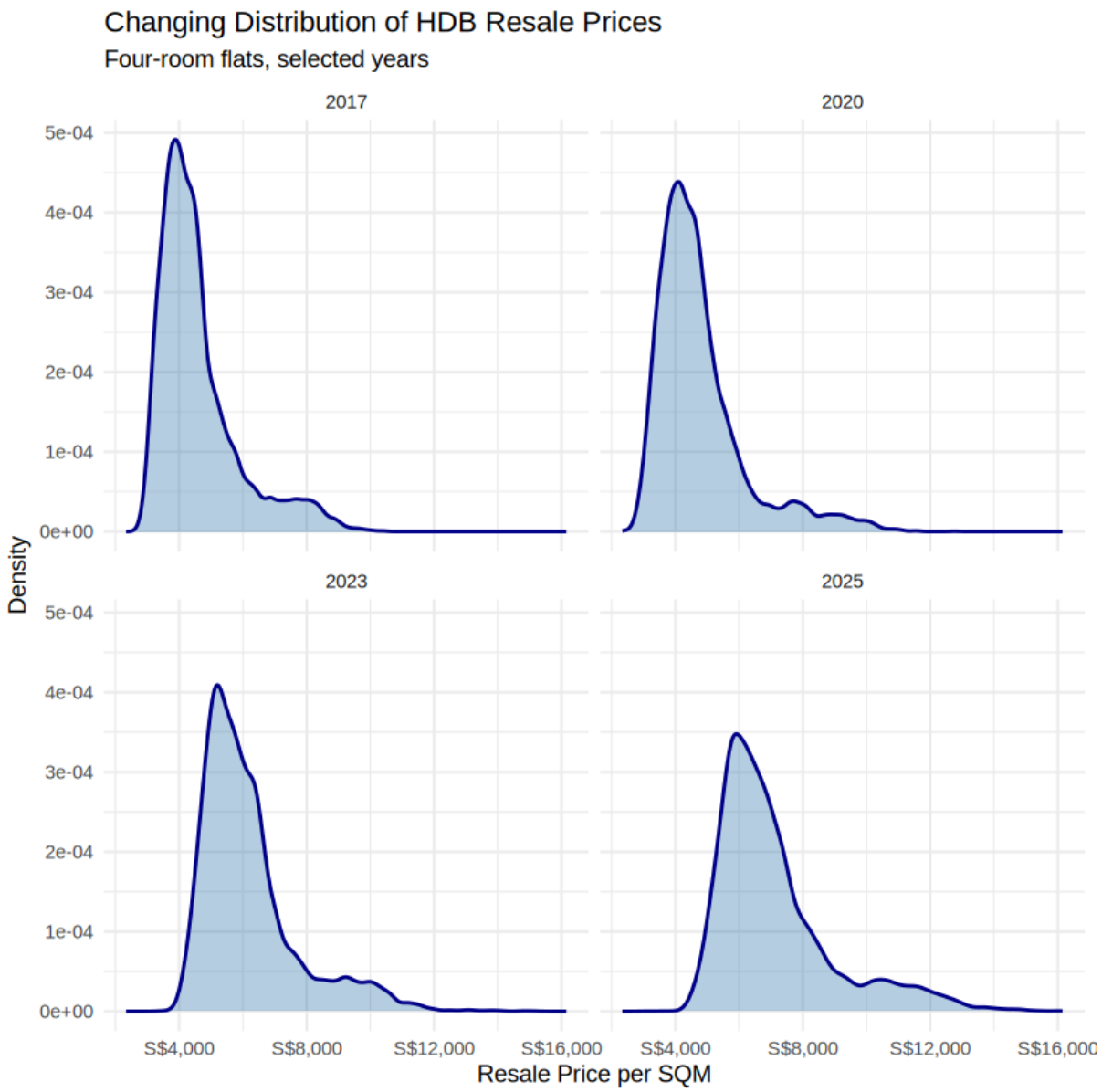
Appendix of Data Visualisations

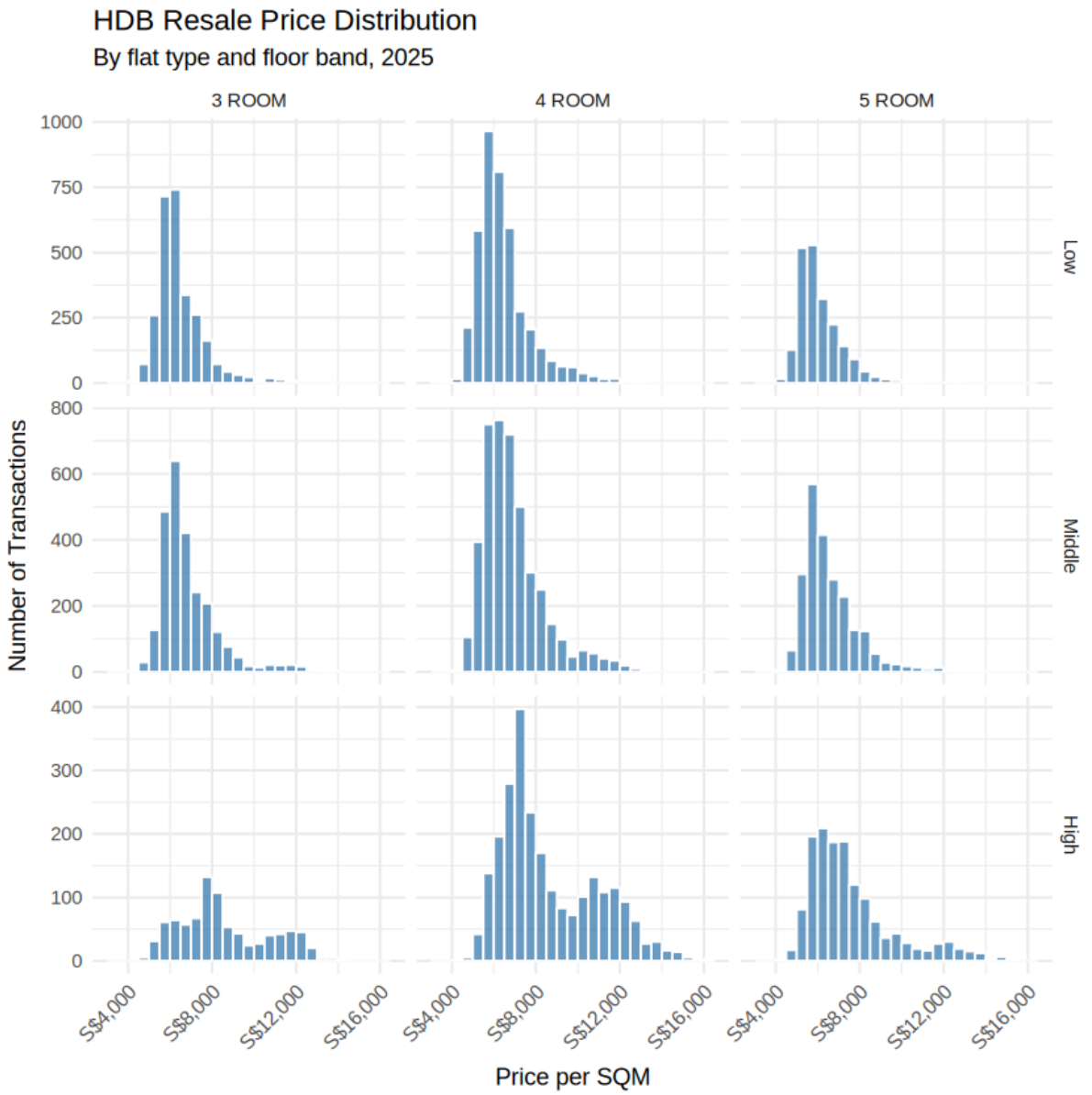


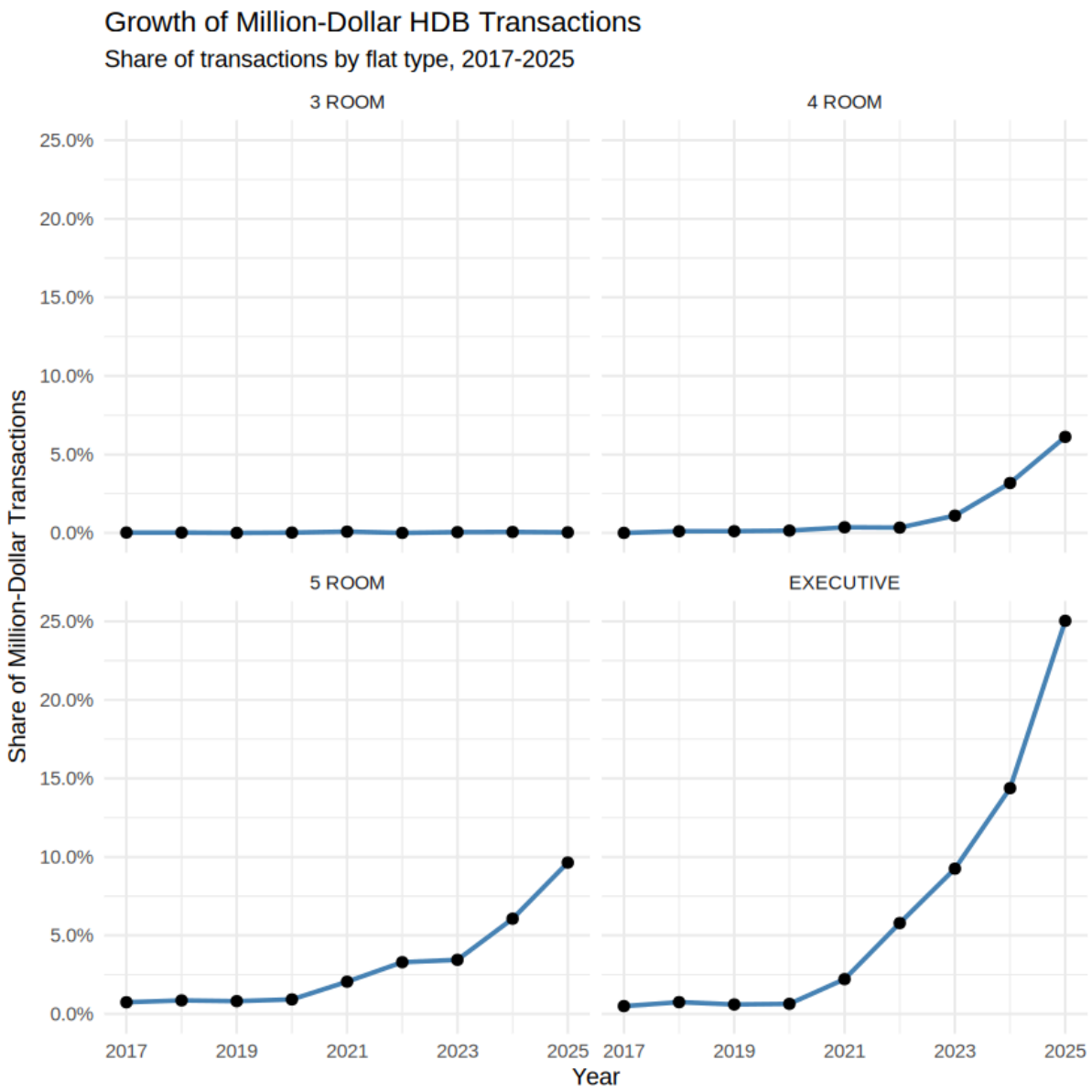

Other towns
Top-5 $1m towns (E4)
SEMBAWANG
WOODLANDS
PASIR RIS
SENGKANG
CHOA CHU KANG
PUNGGOL
BUKIT PANJANG
HOUGANG
SERANGOON
YISHUN
JURONG WEST
TAMPINES
BUKIT BATOK
BEDOK
GEYLANG
BISHAN
TOA PAYOH
ANG MO KIO
KALLANG/WHAMPOA
JURONG EAST
BUKIT TIMAH
CENTRAL AREA
CLEMENTI
BUKIT MERAH
QUEENSTOWN
MARINE PARADE
0%
20%
40%
60%
Estimated price change, 2017-2025
Model: log(price) ~ year x town + flat type + floor area + flat age + storey. Dashed line = n

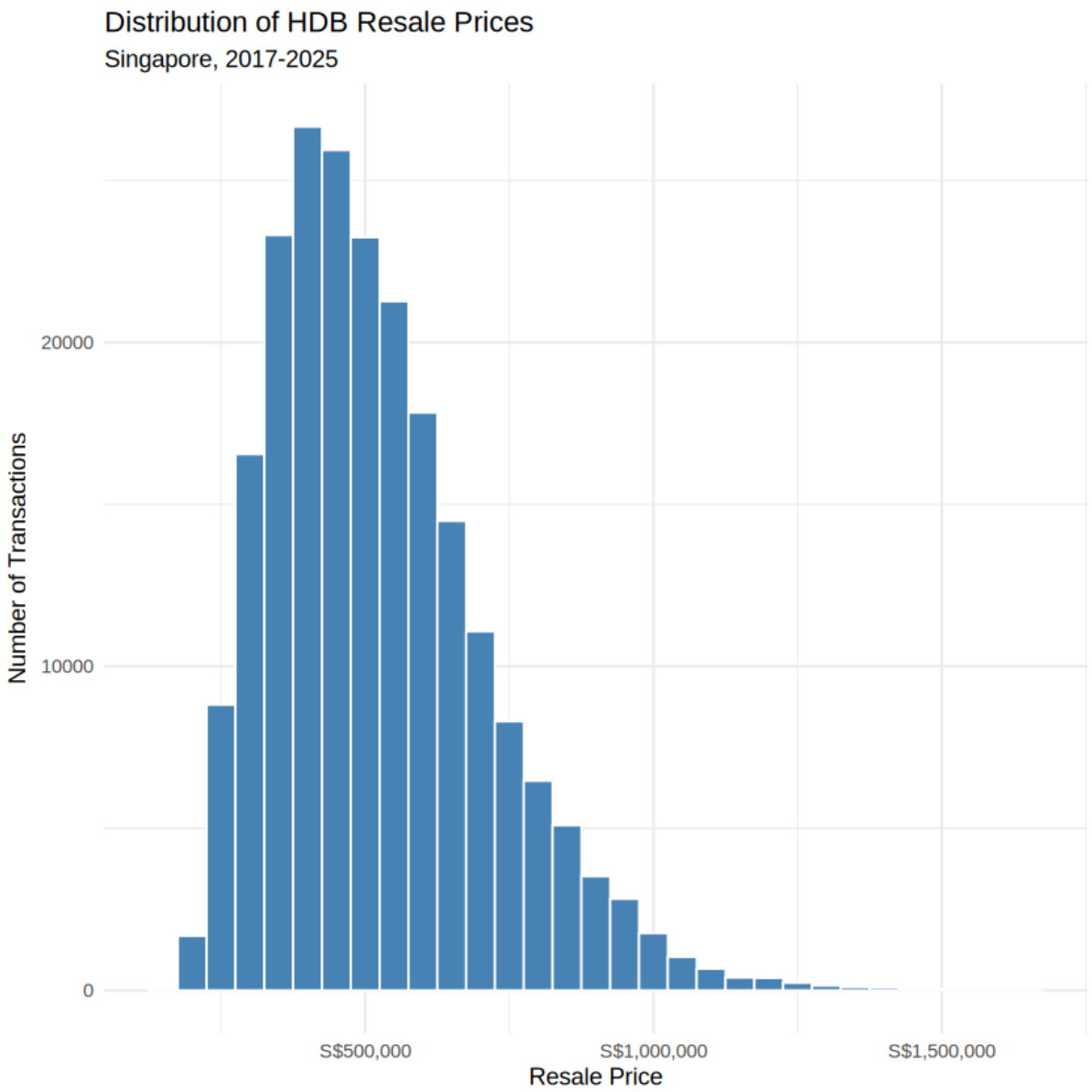

Distribution of Floor Area
3-, 4- and 5-room HDB flats, 2025
3 ROOM
4 ROOM
5 ROOM
Number of Transactions
Floor Area (SQM)
0
1000
2000
3000
4000
500
1500
50
75
100
125
150
175

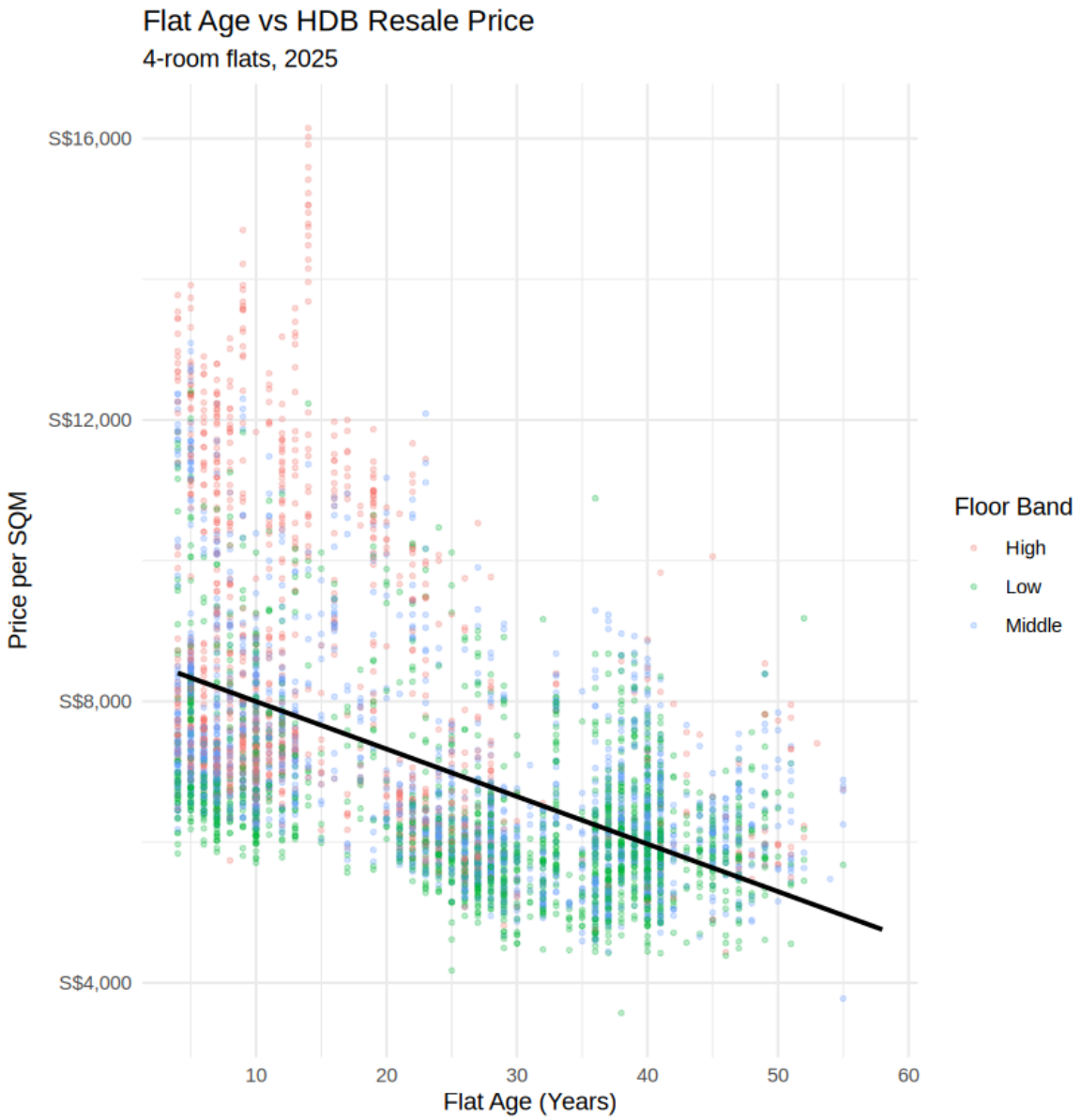

Distribution of HDB Flat Age
Resale transactions in 2025
3 ROOM
4 ROOM
5 ROOM
Number of Transactions
Approximate Flat Age (Years)
0
500
1000
1500
2000
2500
0
20
40
60

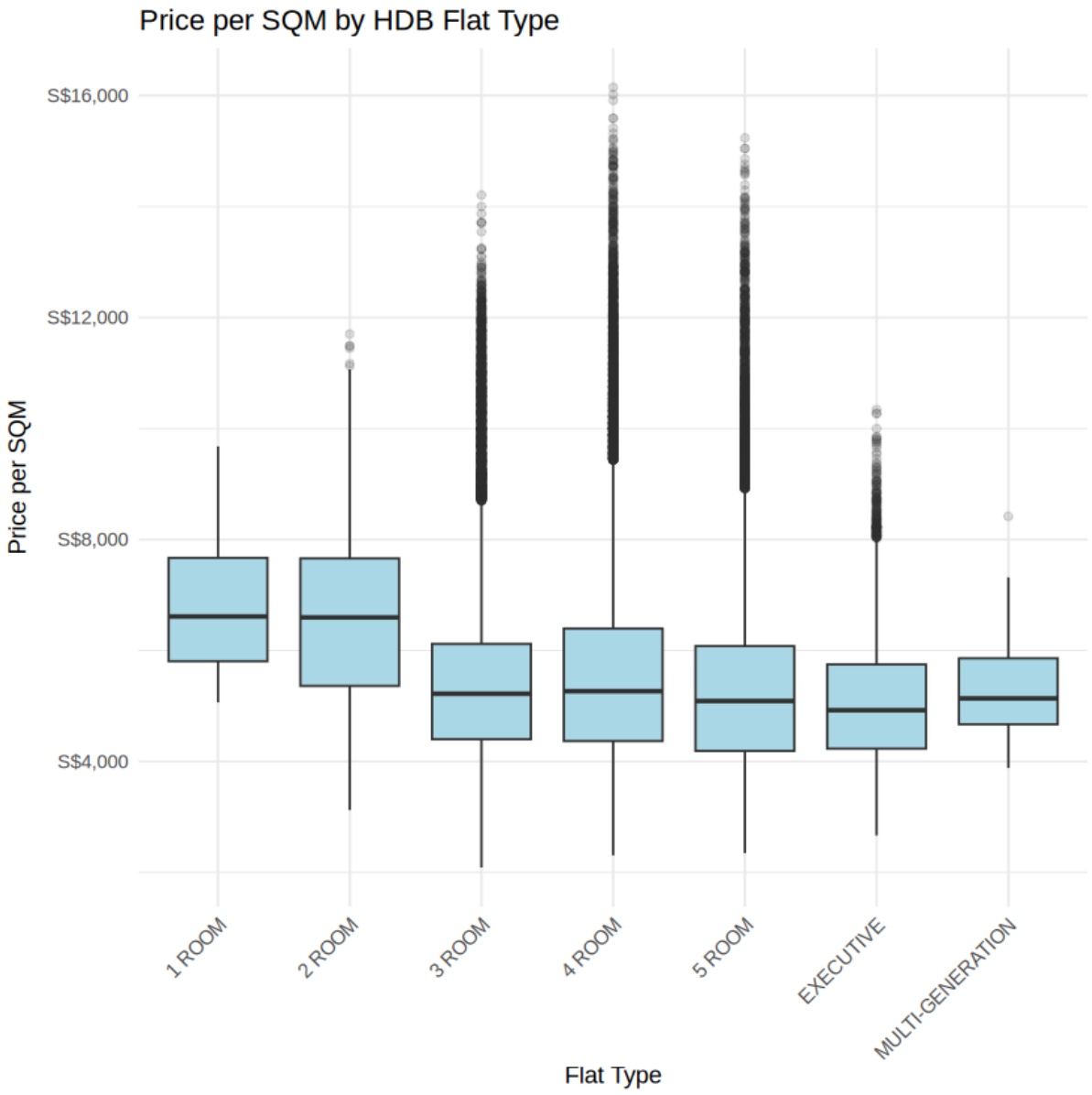

Changing Distribution of HDB Resale Prices
Four-room flats, selected years
2017
2020
2023
2025
Density
5e-04
4e-04
3e-04
2e-04
1e-04
0e+00
S$4,000
S$8,000
S$12,000
S$16,000
Resale Price per SQM

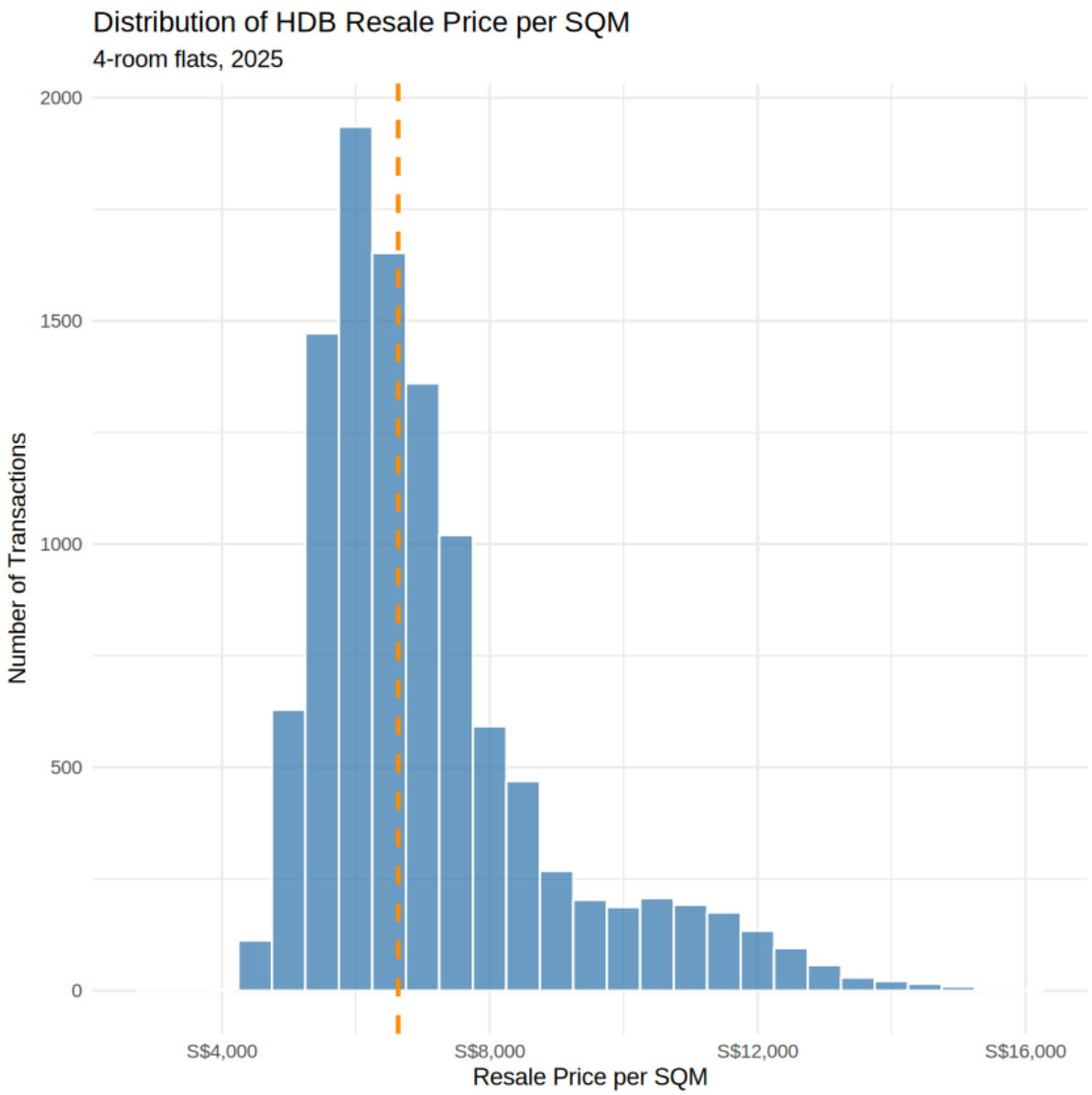

HDB Resale Price Distribution
By flat type and floor band, 2025
3 ROOM
4 ROOM
5 ROOM
Low
Middle
High
Number of Transactions
1000
750
500
250
0
800
600
400
200
0
400
300
200
100
0
S$4,000
S$8,000
S$12,000
S$16,000
Price per SQM

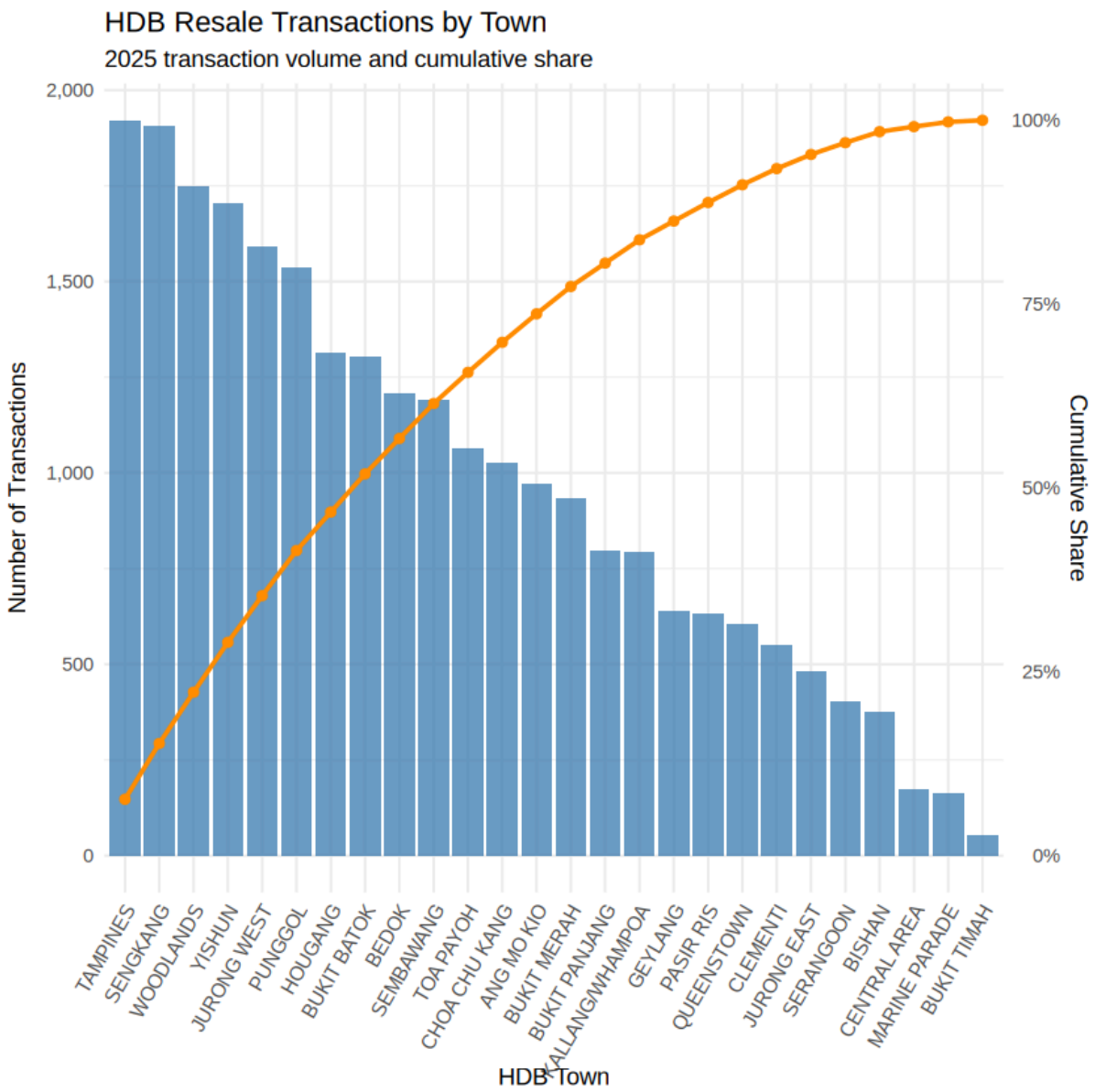

Growth of Million-Dollar HDB Transactions
Share of transactions by flat type, 2017-2025
3 ROOM
4 ROOM
5 ROOM
EXECUTIVE
Share of Million-Dollar Transactions
25.0%
20.0%
15.0%
10.0%
5.0%
0.0%
2017
2019
2021
2023
2025
Year

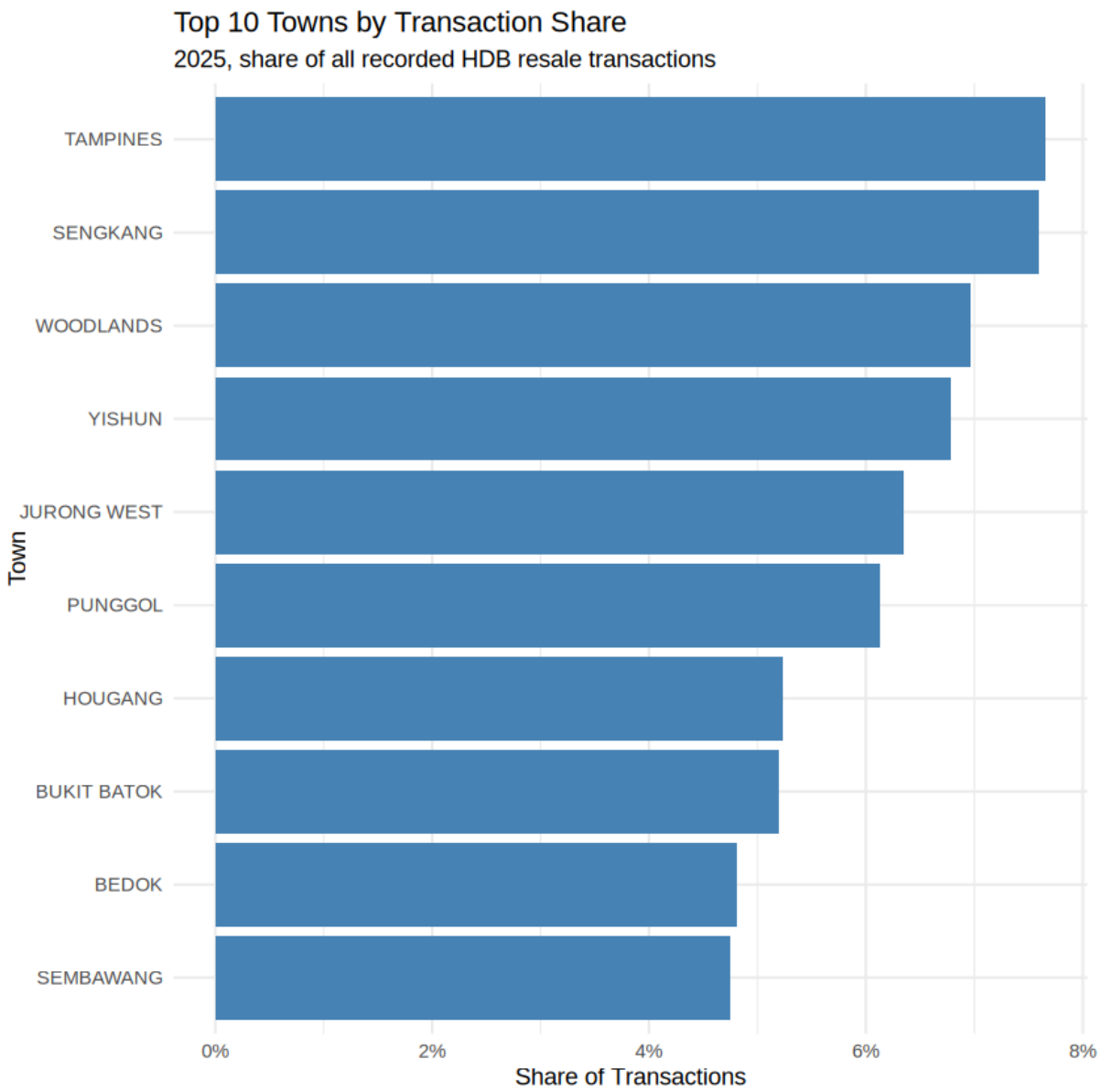

Distribution of HDB Resale Prices
Singapore, 2017-2025
Number of Transactions
20000
10000
0
S$500,000
S$1,000,000
S$1,500,000
Resale Price

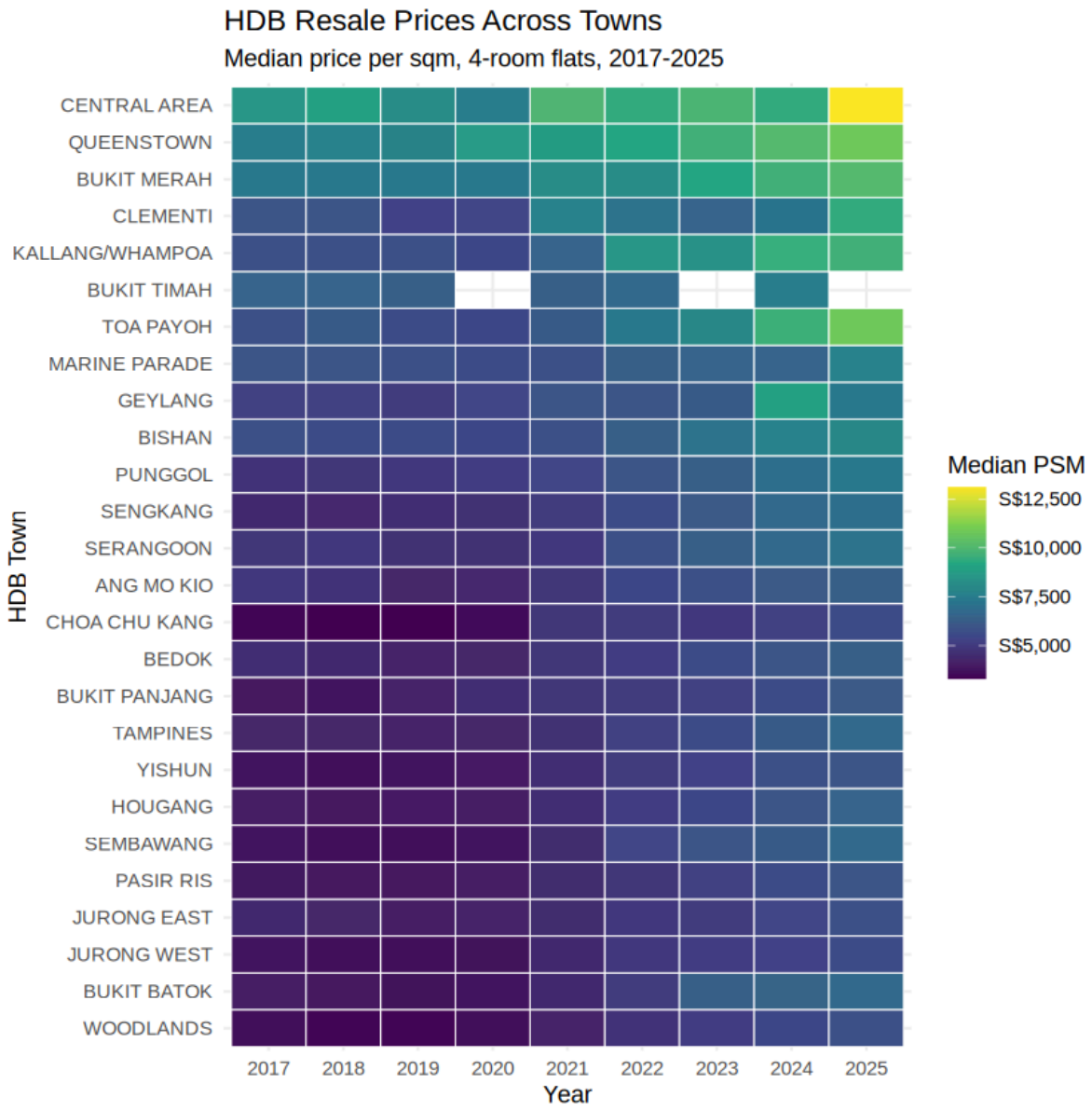

Flat Age vs HDB Resale Price
4-room flats, 2025
S$16,000
S$12,000
S$8,000
S$4,000
Price per SQM
10
20
30
40
50
60
Flat Age (Years)
Floor Band
High
Low
Middle

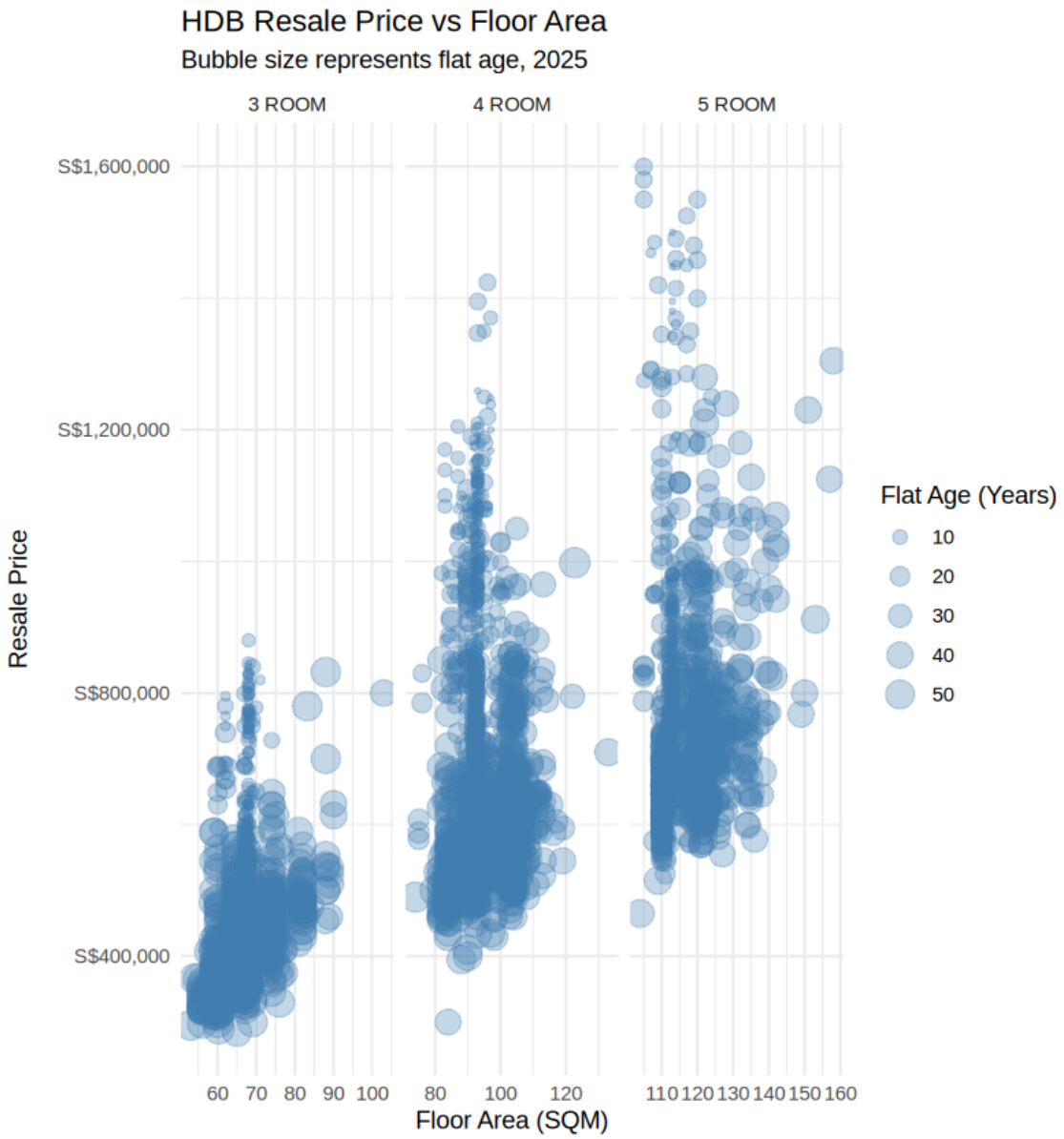

Price per SQM by HDB Flat Type
S$16,000
S$12,000
S$8,000
S$4,000
Price per SQM
1 ROOM
2 ROOM
3 ROOM
4 ROOM
5 ROOM
EXECUTIVE
MULTI-GENERATION
Flat Type

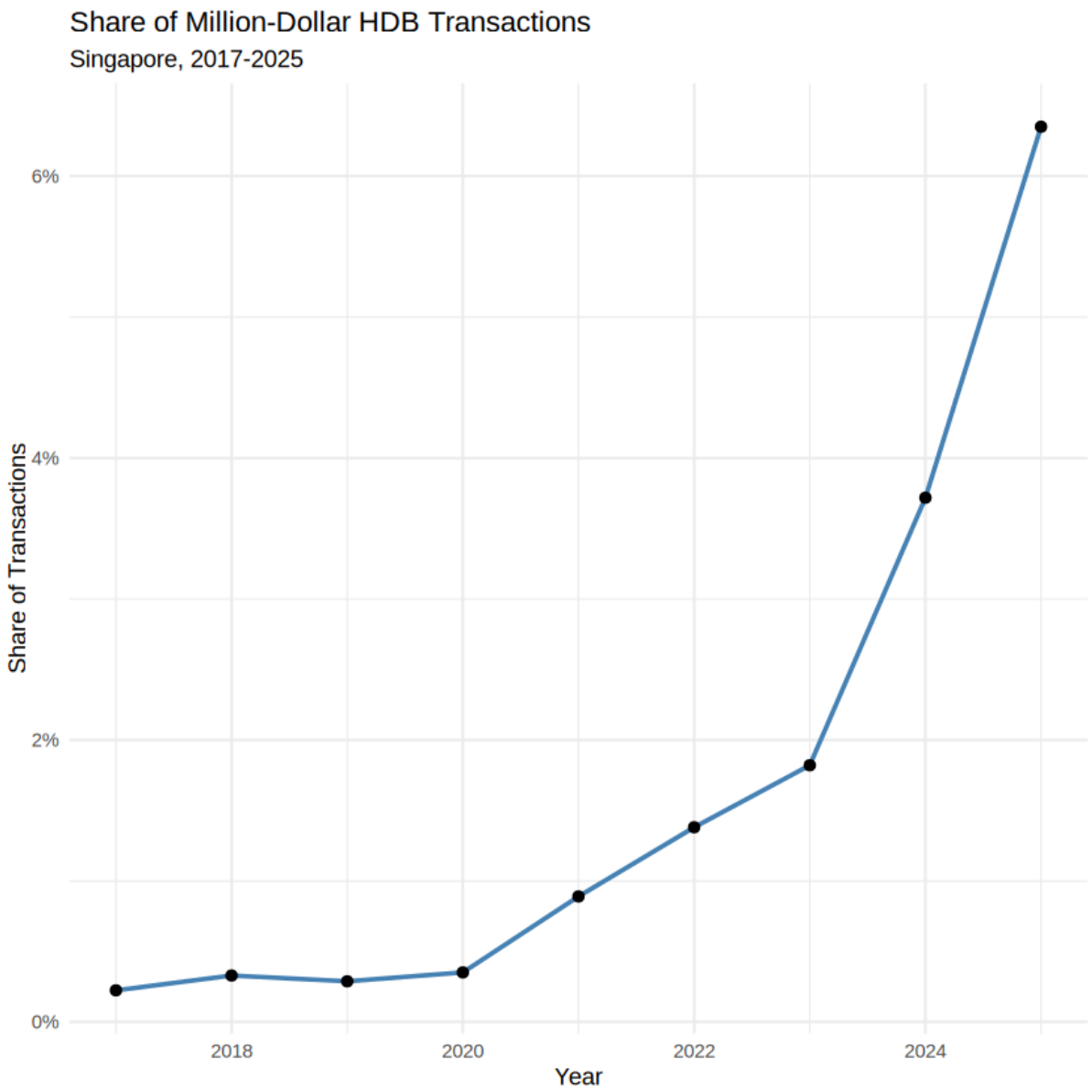

Distribution of HDB Resale Price per SQM
4-room flats, 2025
Number of Transactions
2000
1500
1000
500
0
S$4,000
S$8,000
S$12,000
S$16,000
Resale Price per SQM

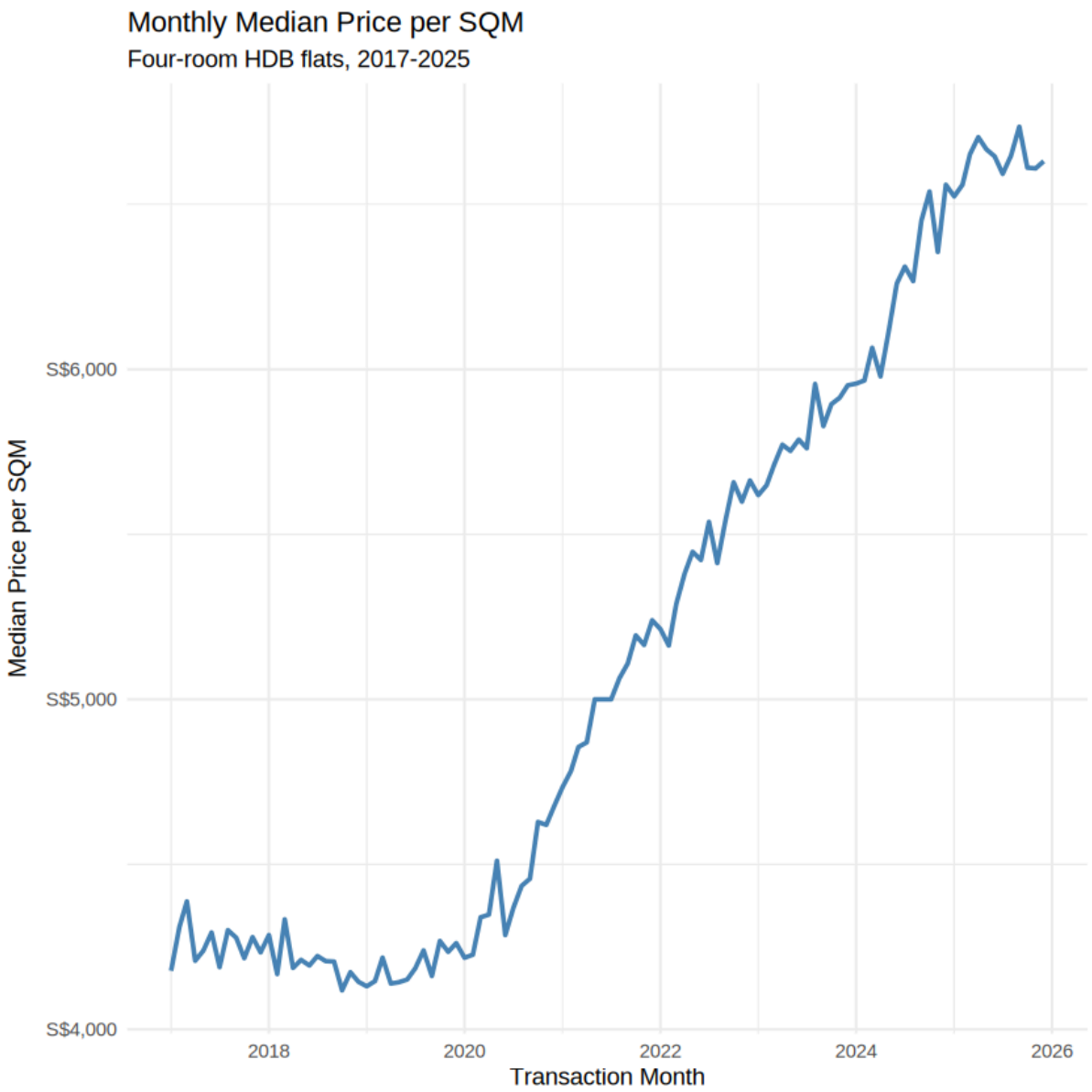

HDB Resale Transactions by Town
2025 transaction volume and cumulative share
Number of Transactions
Cumulative Share
2,000
1,500
1,000
500
0
100%
75%
50%
25%
0%
TAMPINES
SENGKANG
WOODLANDS
YISHUN
JURONG WEST
PUNGGOL
HOUGANG
BUKIT BATOK
BEDOK
SEMBAWANG
TOA PAYOH
CHOA CHU KANG
ANG MO KIO
BUKIT MERAH
BUKIT PANJANG
KALLANG/WHAMPOA
GEYLANG
PASIR RIS
QUEENSTOWN
CLEMENTI
JURONG EAST
SERANGOON
BISHAN
CENTRAL AREA
MARINE PARADE
BUKIT TIMAH
HDB Town

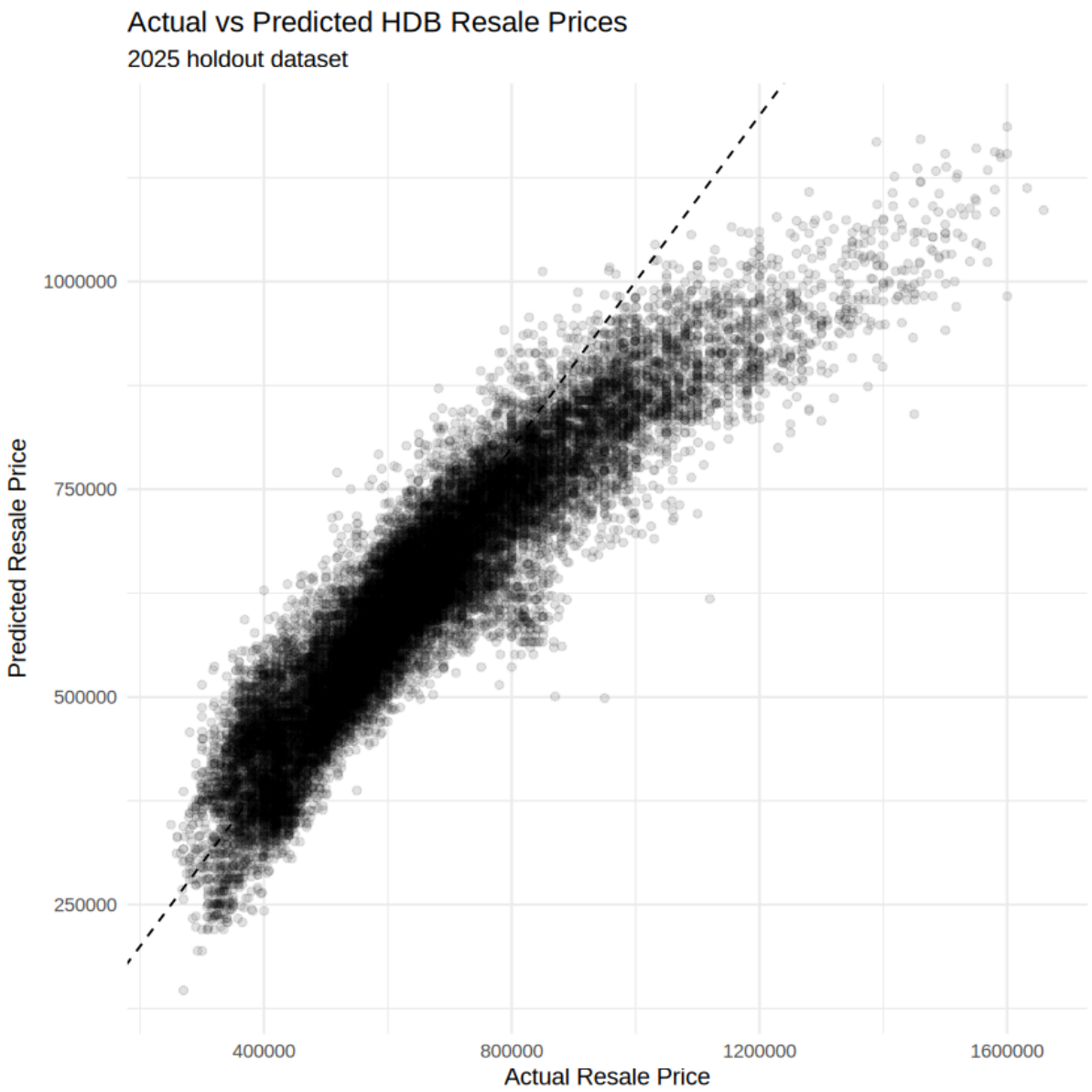

Top 10 Towns by Transaction Share
2025, share of all recorded HDB resale transactions
TAMPINES
SENGKANG
WOODLANDS
YISHUN
JURONG WEST
PUNGGOL
HOUGANG
BUKIT BATOK
BEDOK
SEMBAWANG
Town
0%
2%
4%
6%
8%
Share of Transactions

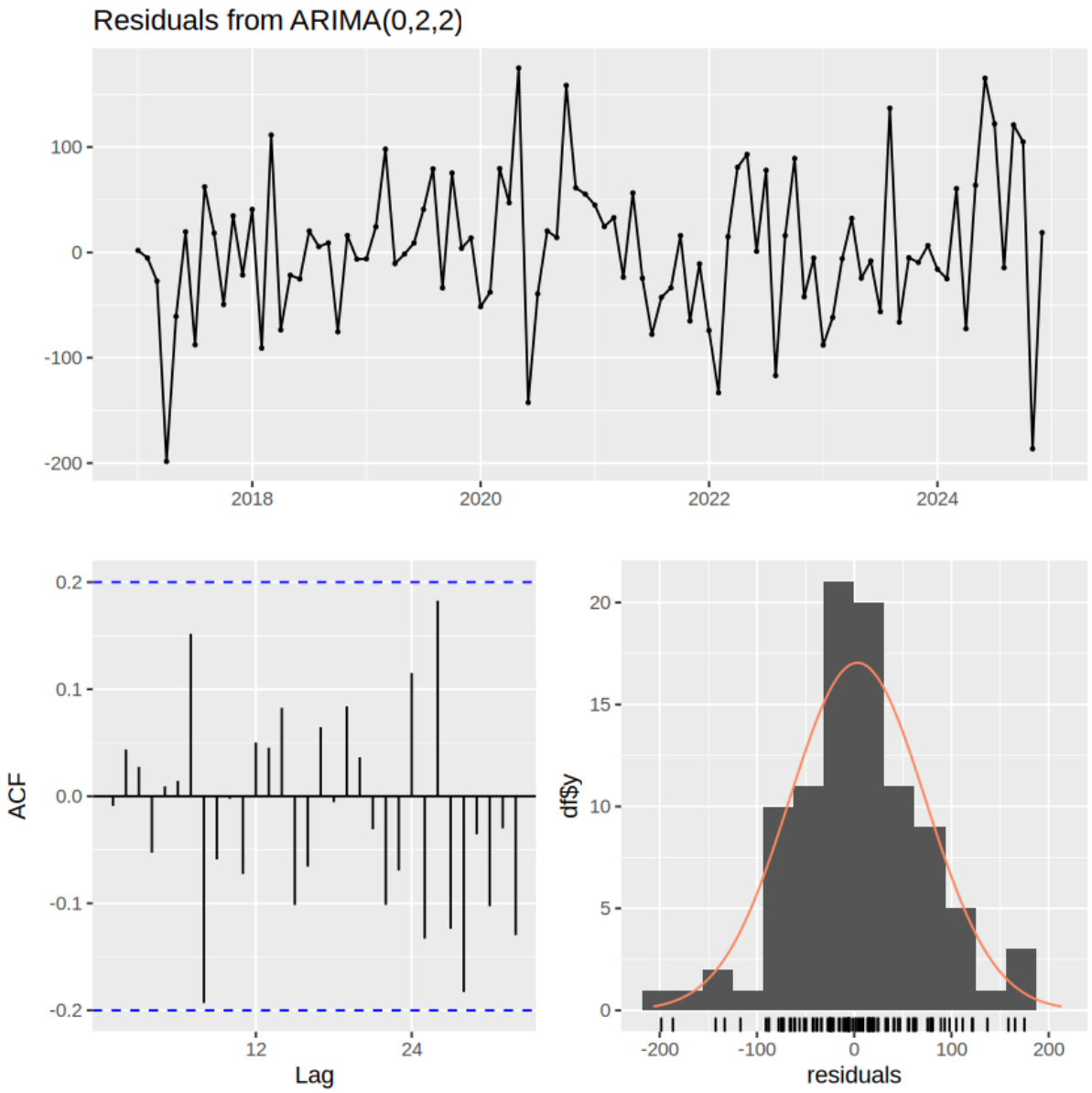

HDB Resale Prices Across Towns
Median price per sqm, 4-room flats, 2017-2025
CENTRAL AREA
QUEENSTOWN
BUKIT MERAH
CLEMENTI
KALLANG/WHAMPOA
BUKIT TIMAH
TOA PAYOH
MARINE PARADE
GEYLANG
BISHAN
PUNGGOL
SENGKANG
SERANGOON
ANG MO KIO
CHOA CHU KANG
BEDOK
BUKIT PANJANG
TAMPINES
YISHUN
HOUGANG
SEMBAWANG
PASIR RIS
JURONG EAST
JURONG WEST
BUKIT BATOK
WOODLANDS
HDB Town
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
Year
Median PSM
S$12,500
S$10,000
S$7,500
S$5,000

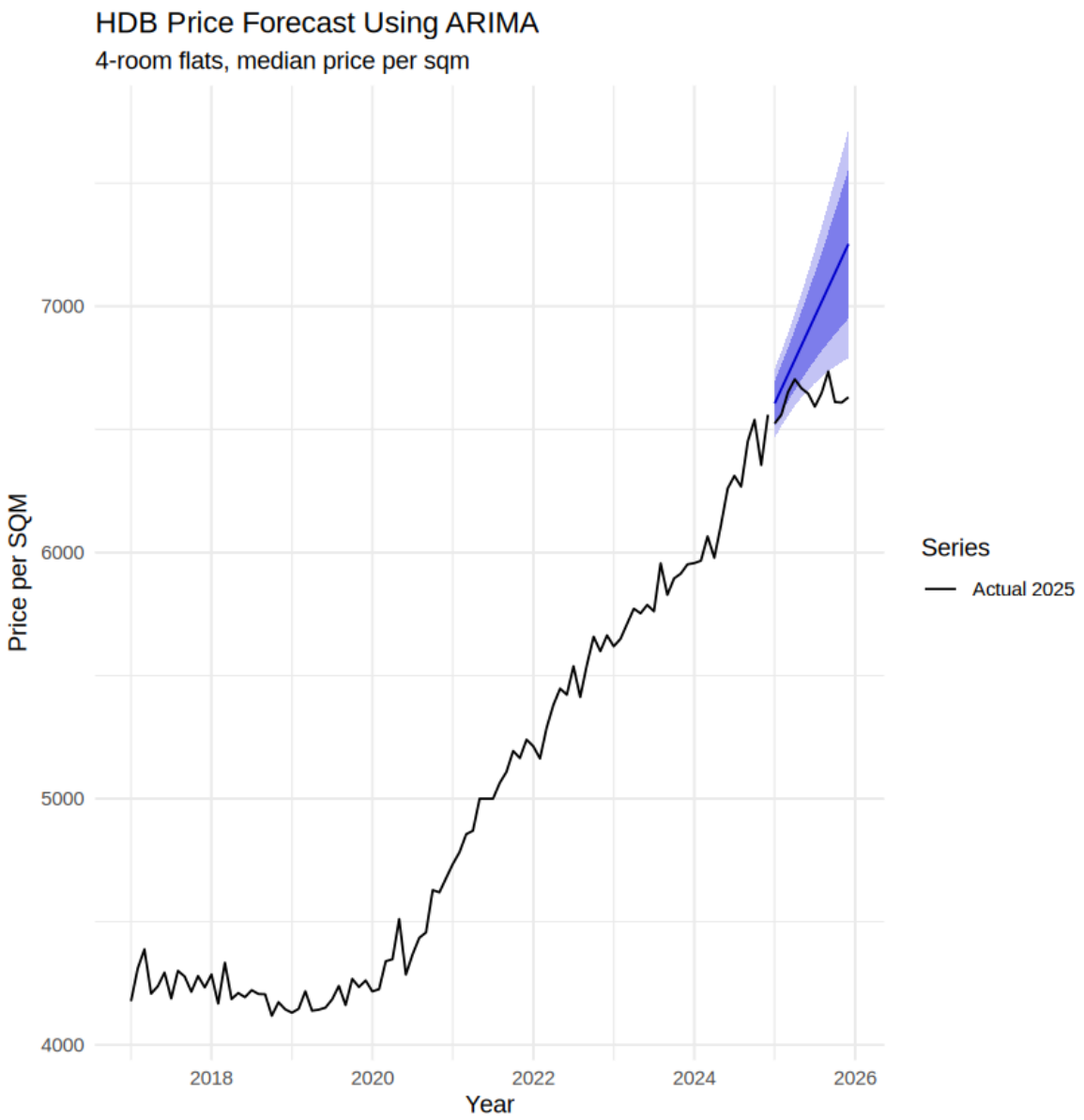

HDB Resale Price vs Floor Area
Bubble size represents flat age, 2025
3 ROOM
4 ROOM
5 ROOM
S$1,600,000
S$1,200,000
S$800,000
S$400,000
Resale Price
60 70 80 90 100
80 100 120
110 120 130 140 150 160
Floor Area (SQM)
Flat Age (Years)
10
20
30
40
50

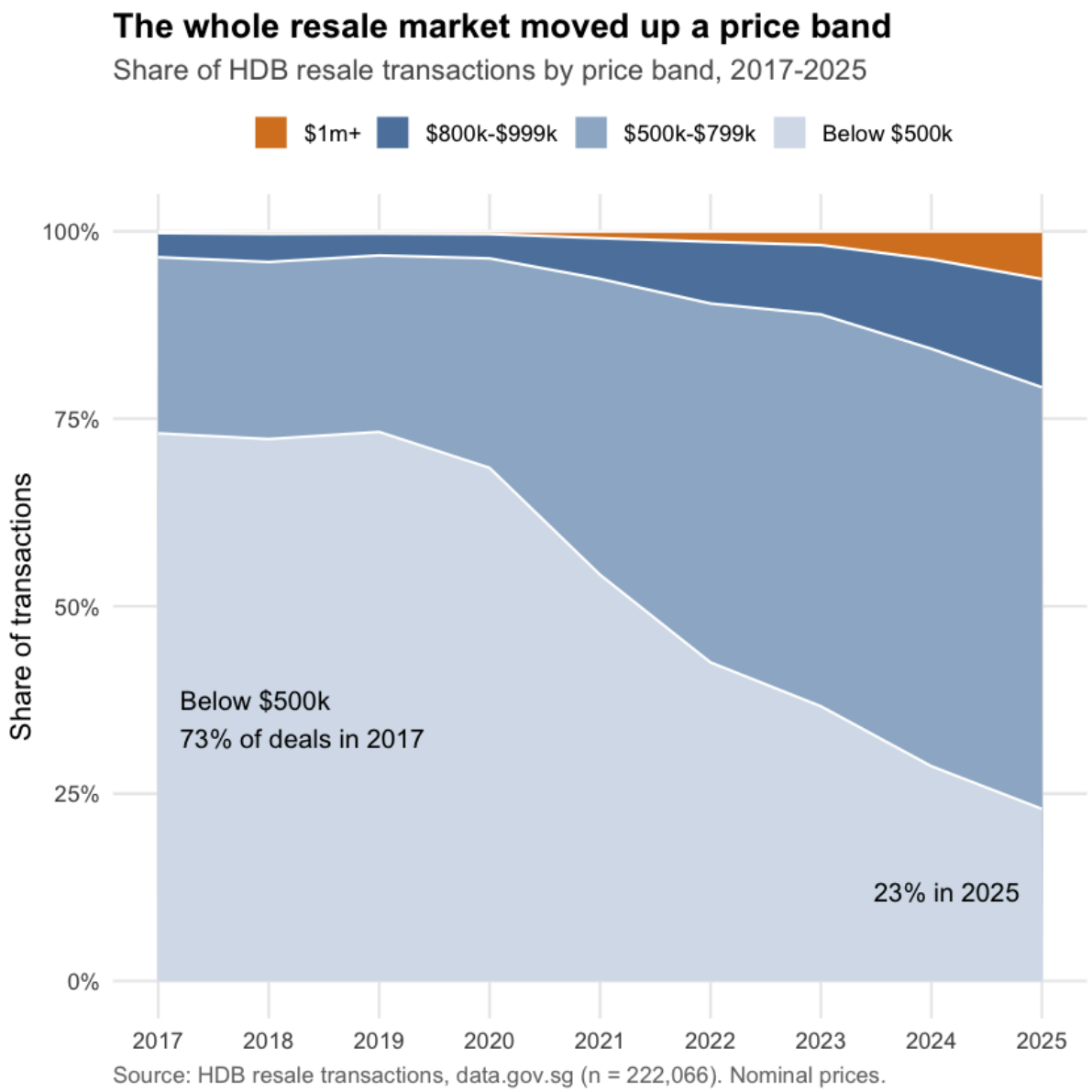

Share of Million-Dollar HDB Transactions
Singapore, 2017-2025
6%
4%
2%
0%
Share of Transactions
2018
2020
2022
2024
Year


Monthly Median Price per SQM
Four-room HDB flats, 2017-2025
Median Price per SQM
S$6,000
S$5,000
S$4,000
2018
2020
2022
2024
2026
Transaction Month

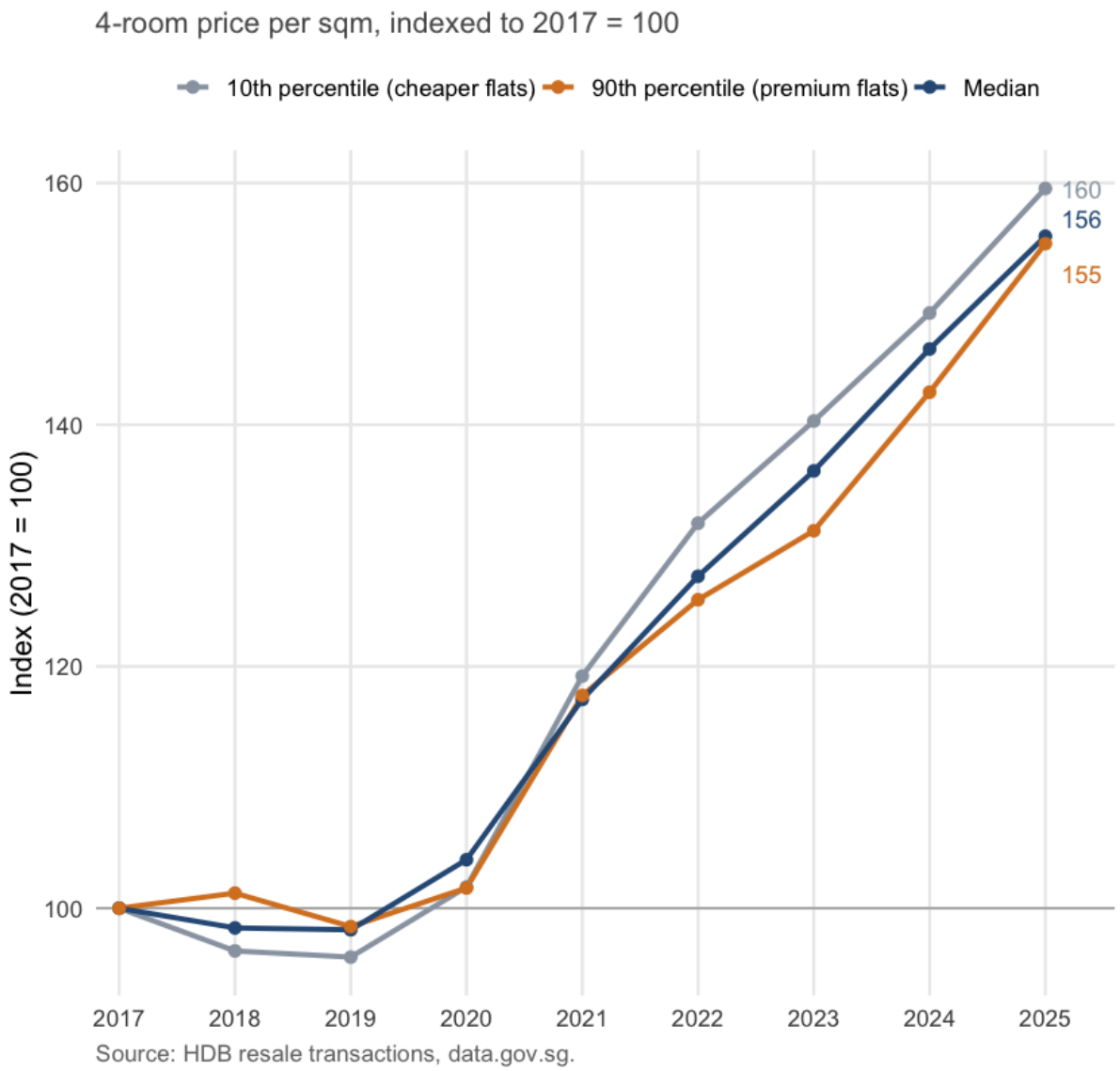

Actual vs Predicted HDB Resale Prices
2025 holdout dataset
Predicted Resale Price
1000000
750000
500000
250000
400000
800000
1200000
1600000
Actual Resale Price

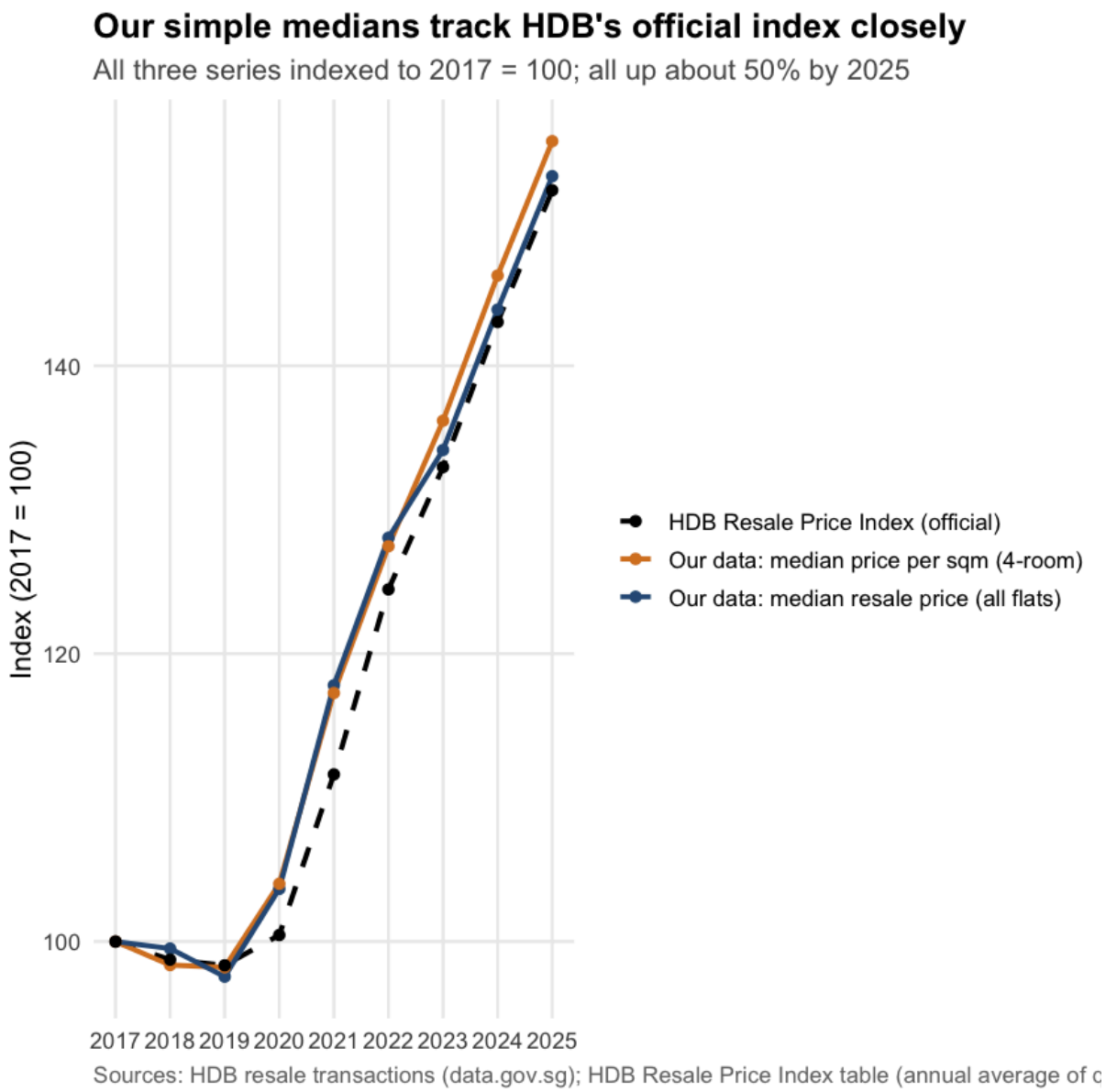

Residuals from ARIMA(0,2,2)
100
0
-100
-200
2018
2020
2022
2024
0.2
0.1
0.0
-0.1
-0.2
ACF
12
24
Lag
20
15
10
5
0
df$y
-200
-100
0
100
200
residuals

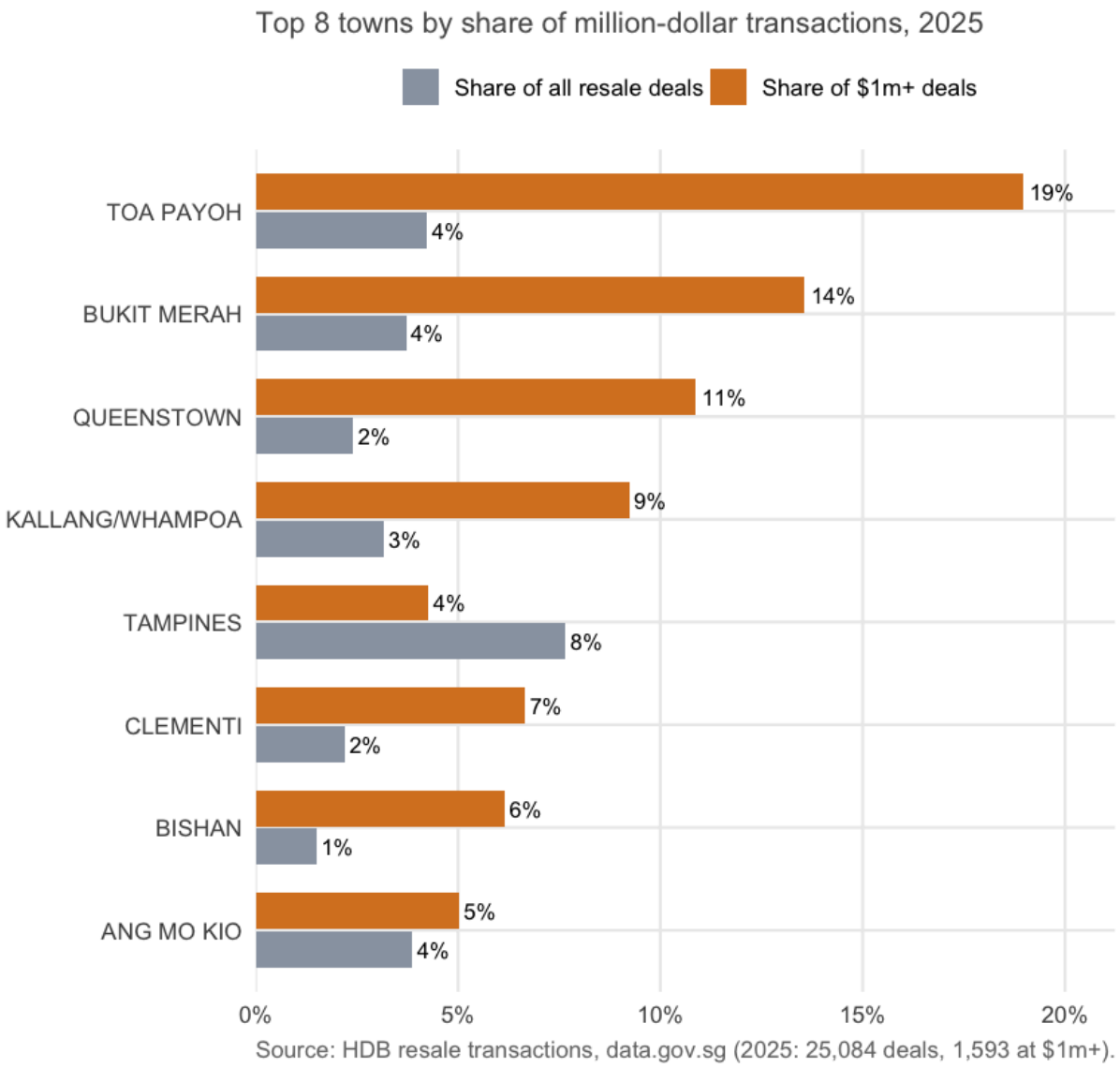

HDB Price Forecast Using ARIMA
4-room flats, median price per sqm
Price per SQM
7000
6000
5000
4000
2018
2020
2022
2024
2026
Year
Series
Actual 2025

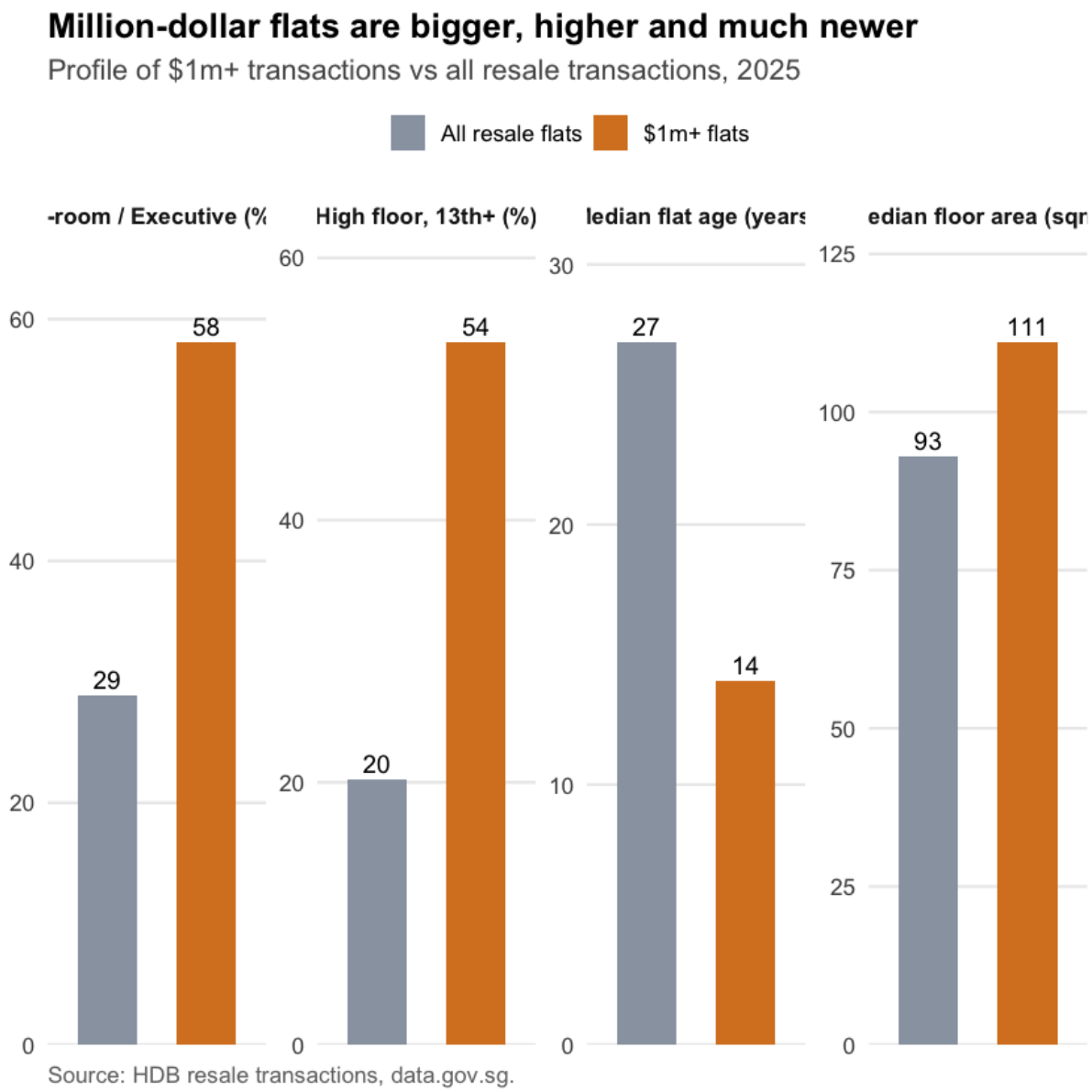

The whole resale market moved up a price band
Share of HDB resale transactions by price band, 2017-2025
$1m+
$800k-$999k
$500k-$799k
Below $500k
100%
75%
50%
25%
0%
Share of transactions
Below $500k
73% of deals in 2017
23% in 2025
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
Source: HDB resale transactions, data.gov.sg (n = 222,066). Nominal prices.

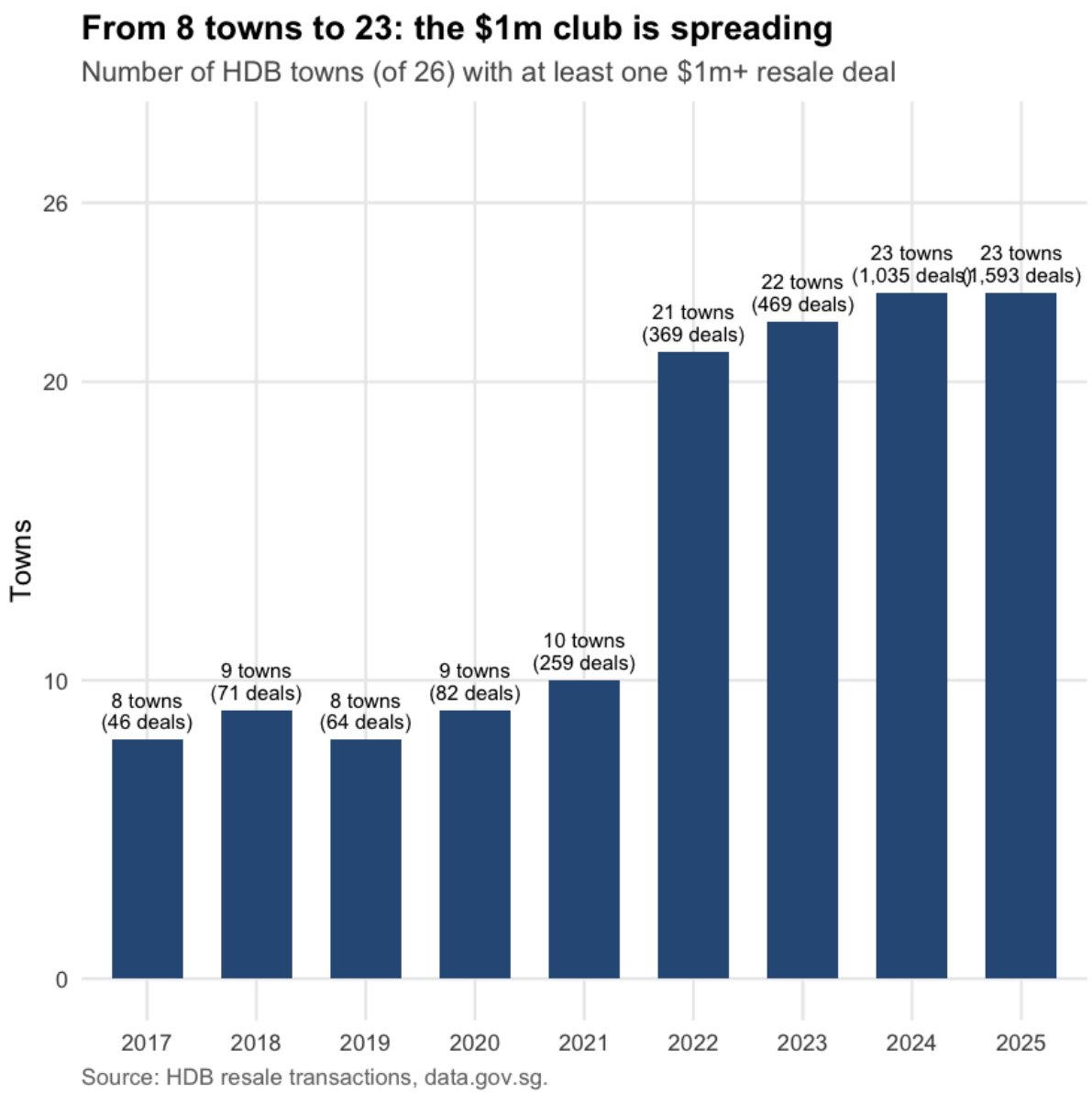
z

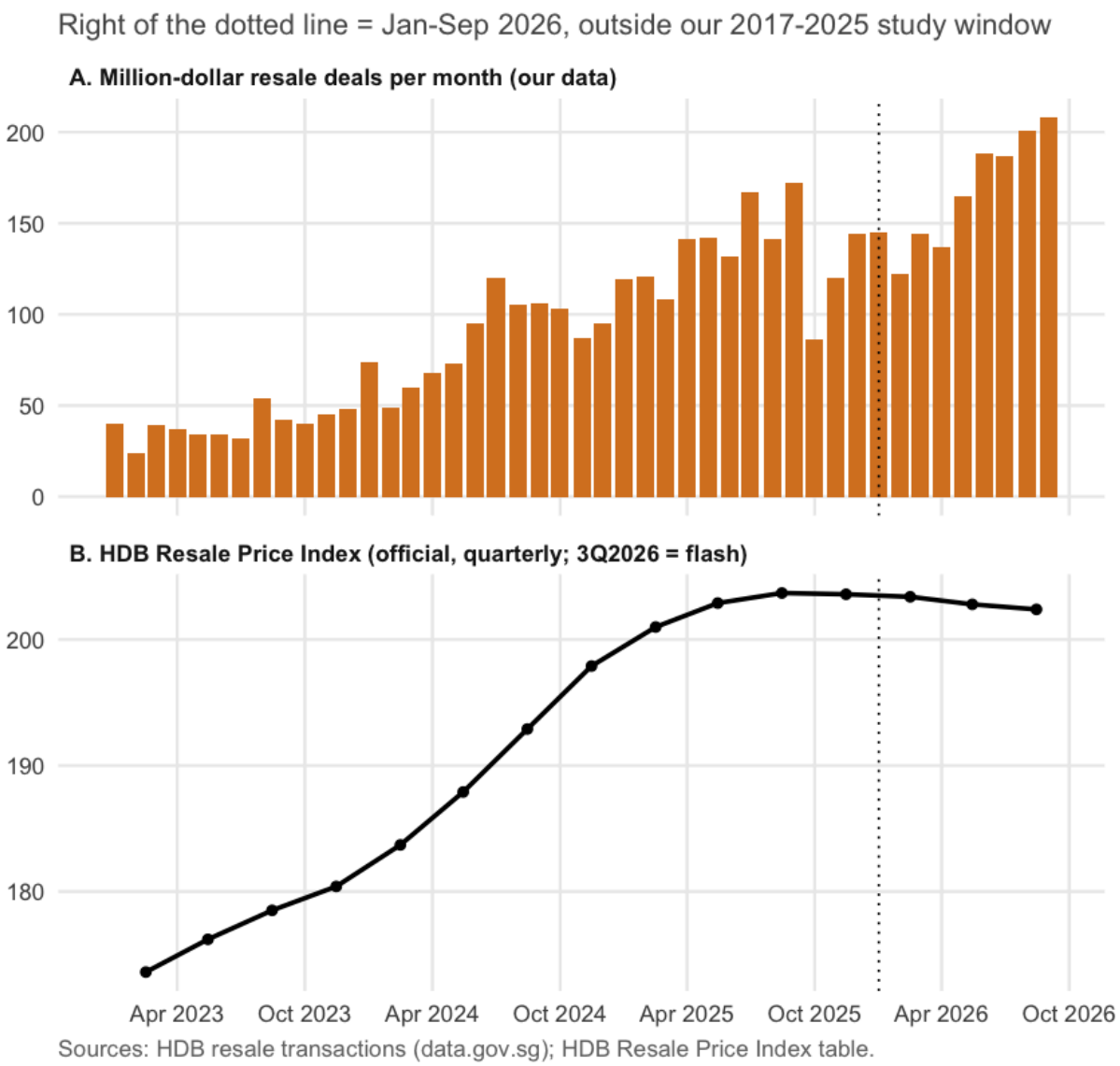

4-room price per sqm, indexed to 2017 = 100
10th percentile (cheaper flats)
90th percentile (premium flats)
Median
Index (2017 = 100)
160
140
120
100
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
160
156
155
Source: HDB resale transactions, data.gov.sg.

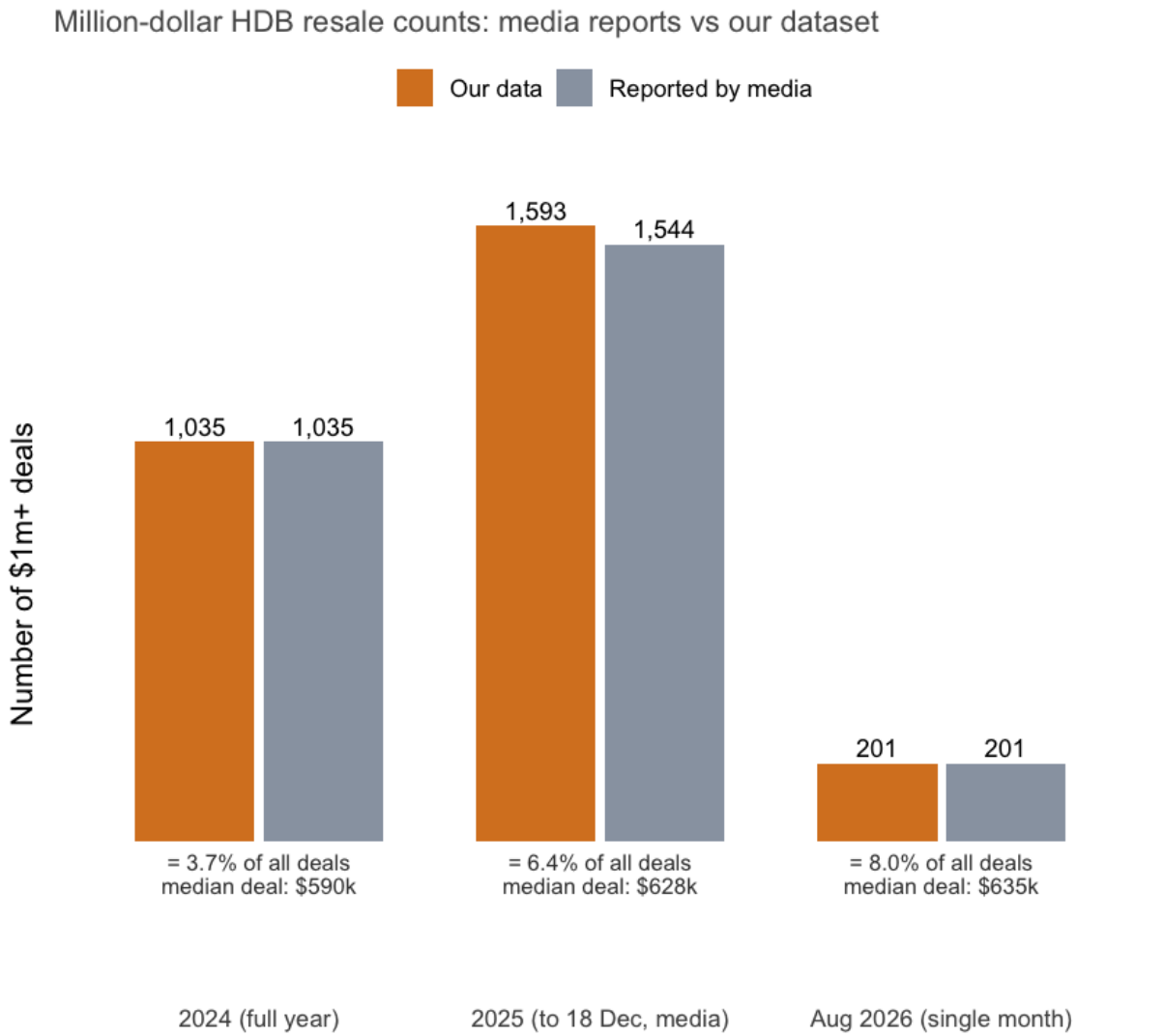

Our simple medians track HDB's official index closely
All three series indexed to 2017 = 100; all up about 50% by 2025
Index (2017 = 100)
140
120
100
2017 2018 2019 2020 2021 2022 2023 2024 2025
HDB Resale Price Index (official)
Our data: median price per sqm (4-room)
Our data: median resale price (all flats)
Sources: HDB resale transactions (data.gov.sg); HDB Resale Price Index table (annual average of c


Top 8 towns by share of million-dollar transactions, 2025
Share of all resale deals
Share of $1m+ deals
TOA PAYOH
19%
4%
BUKIT MERAH
14%
4%
QUEENSTOWN
11%
2%
KALLANG/WHAMPOA
9%
3%
TAMPINES
4%
8%
CLEMENTI
7%
2%
BISHAN
6%
1%
ANG MO KIO
5%
4%
0%
5%
10%
15%
20%
Source: HDB resale transactions, data.gov.sg (2025: 25,084 deals, 1,593 at $1m+).

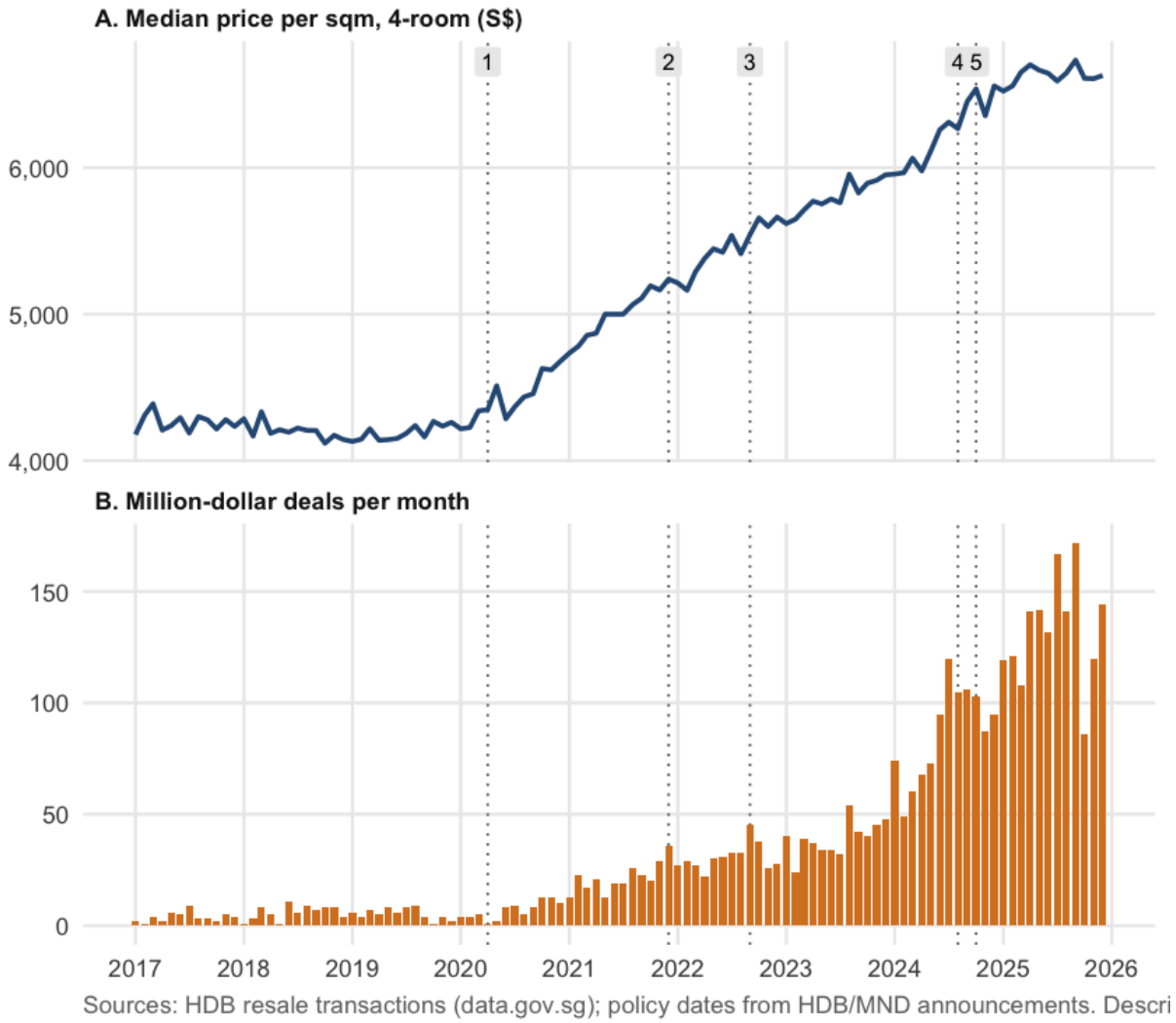

Million-dollar flats are bigger, higher and much newer
Profile of $1m+ transactions vs all resale transactions, 2025
All resale flats
$1m+ flats
-room / Executive (%
High floor, 13th+ (%)
ledian flat age (years
edian floor area (sqr
60
40
20
0
58
29
60
40
20
0
54
20
30
20
10
0
27
14
125
100
75
50
25
0
111
93
Source: HDB resale transactions, data.gov.sg.

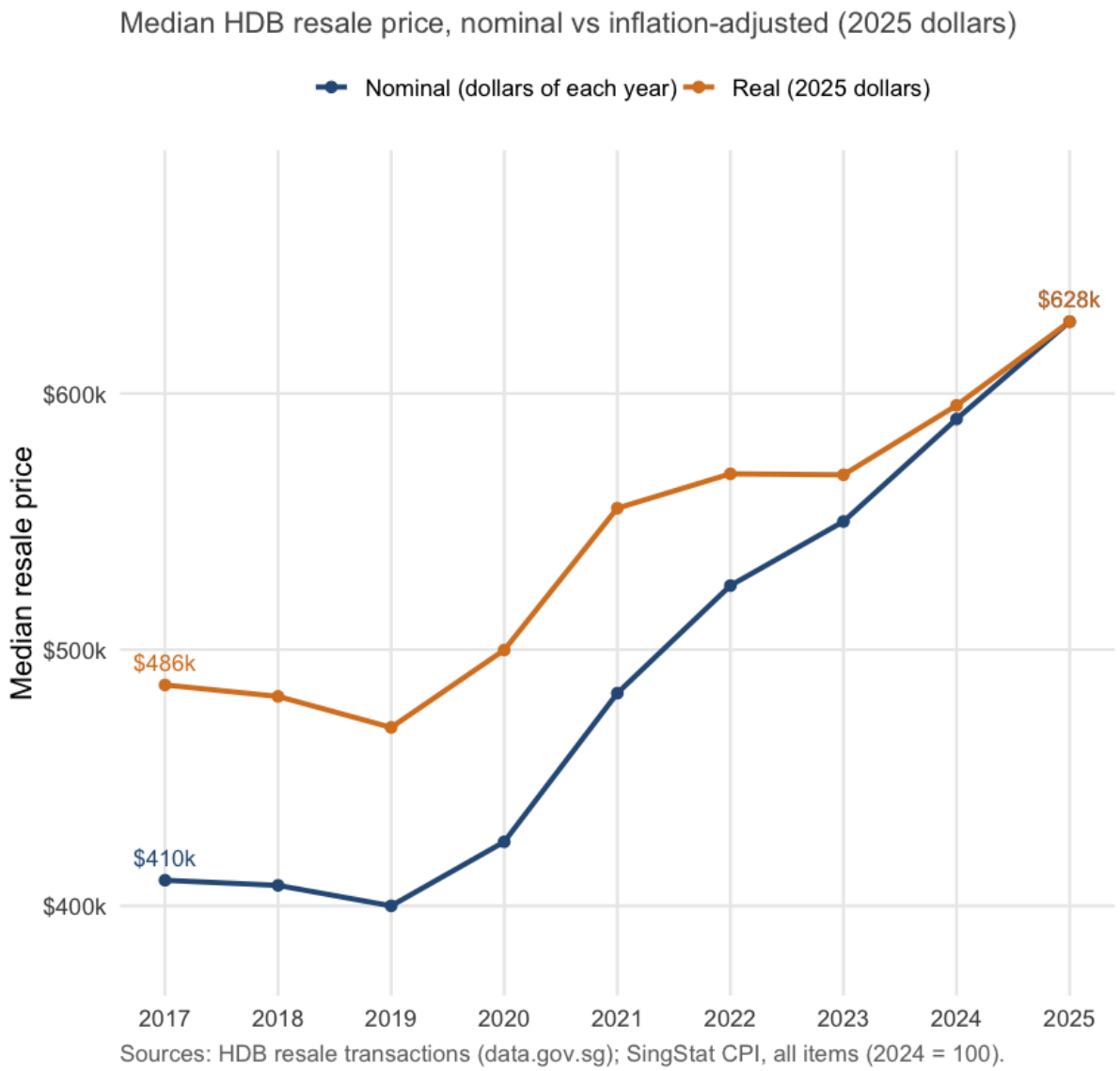

From 8 towns to 23: the $1m club is spreading
Number of HDB towns (of 26) with at least one $1m+ resale deal
Towns
26
20
10
0
8 towns (46 deals)
9 towns (71 deals)
8 towns (64 deals)
9 towns (82 deals)
10 towns (259 deals)
21 towns (369 deals)
22 towns (469 deals)
23 towns (1,035 deals)
23 towns (1,593 deals)
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
Source: HDB resale transactions, data.gov.sg.

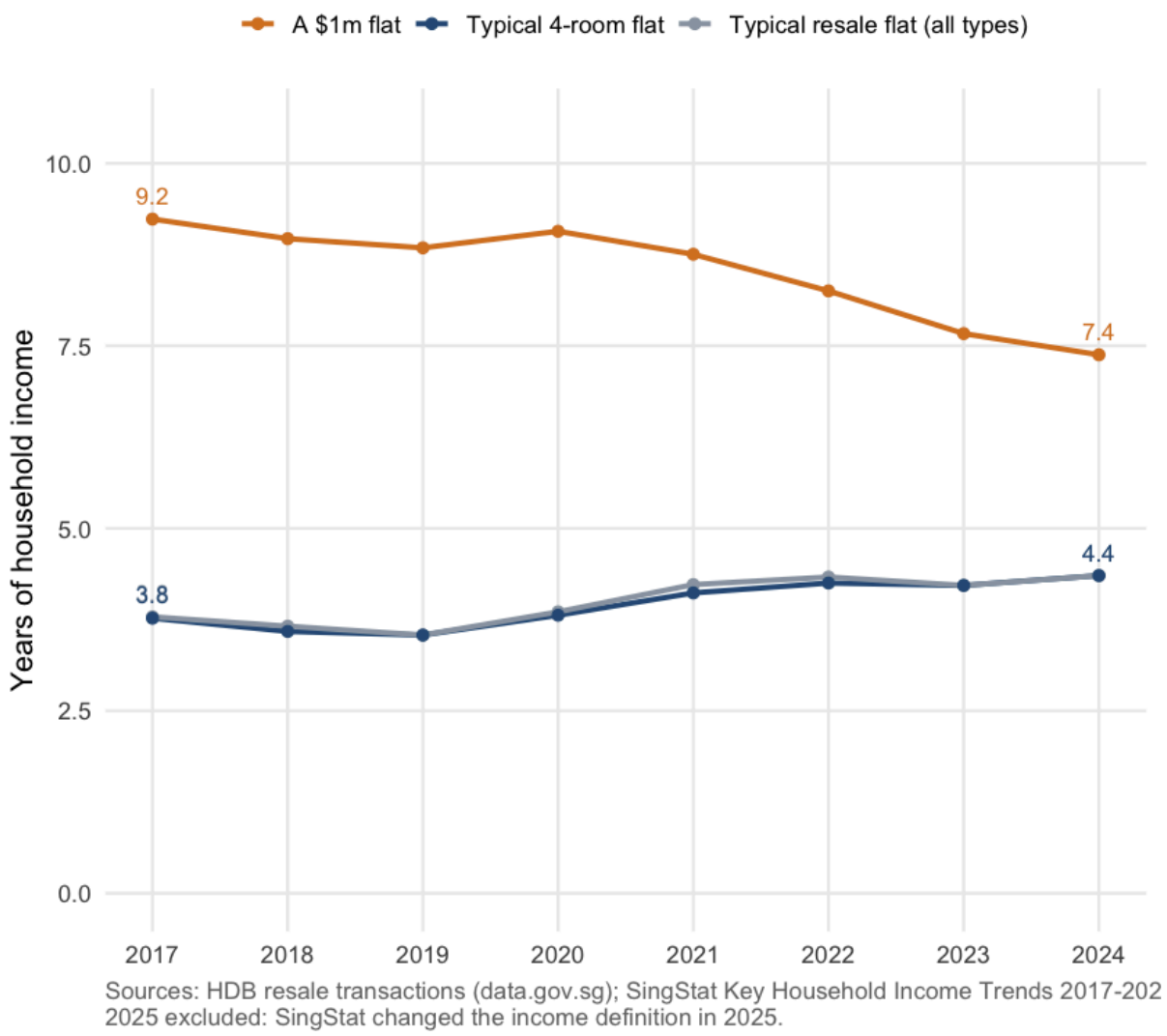

Right of the dotted line = Jan-Sep 2026, outside our 2017-2025 study window
A. Million-dollar resale deals per month (our data)
200
150
100
50
0
B. HDB Resale Price Index (official, quarterly; 3Q2026 = flash)
200
190
180
Apr 2023
Oct 2023
Apr 2024
Oct 2024
Apr 2025
Oct 2025
Apr 2026
Oct 2026
Sources: HDB resale transactions (data.gov.sg); HDB Resale Price Index table.

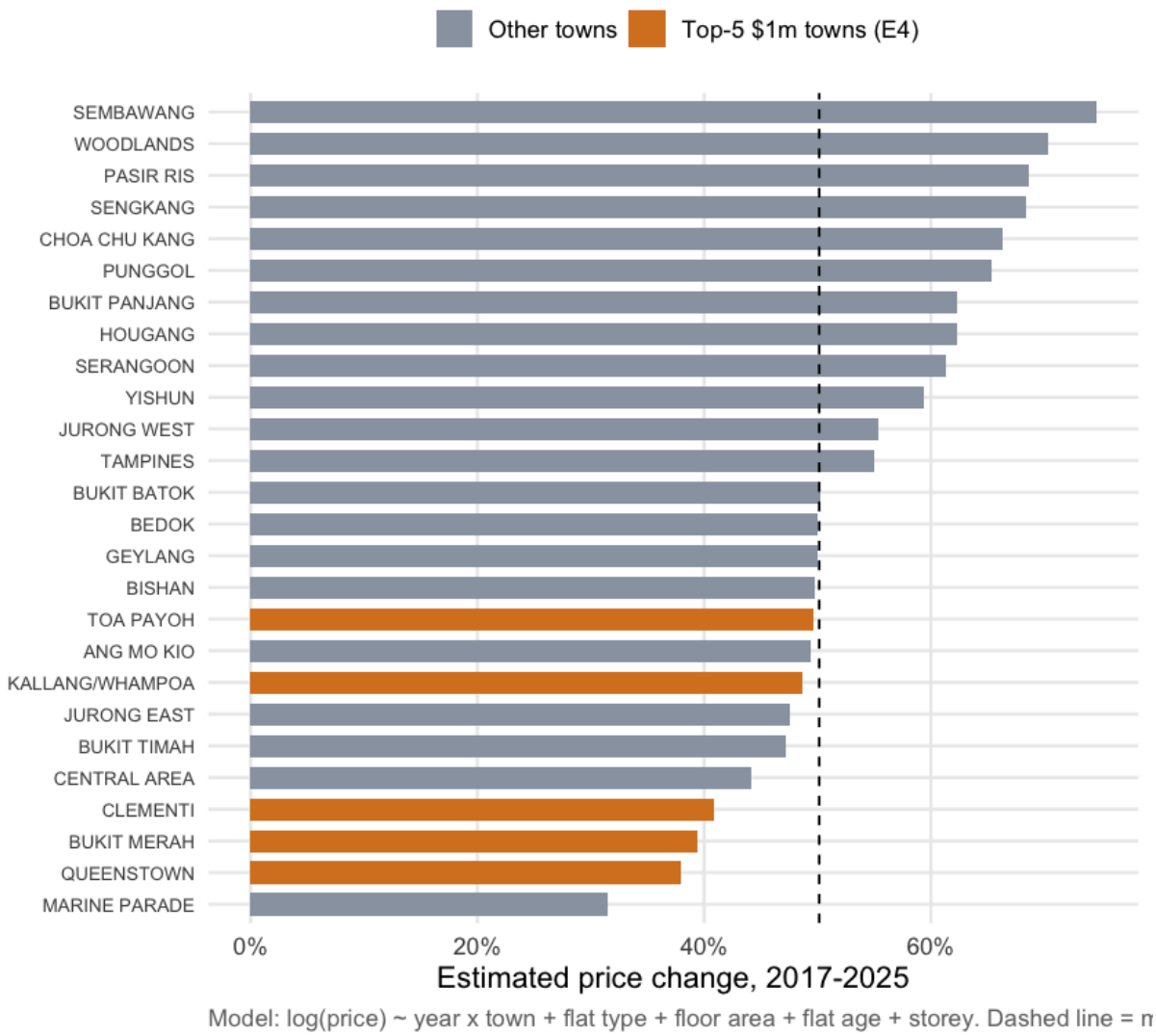


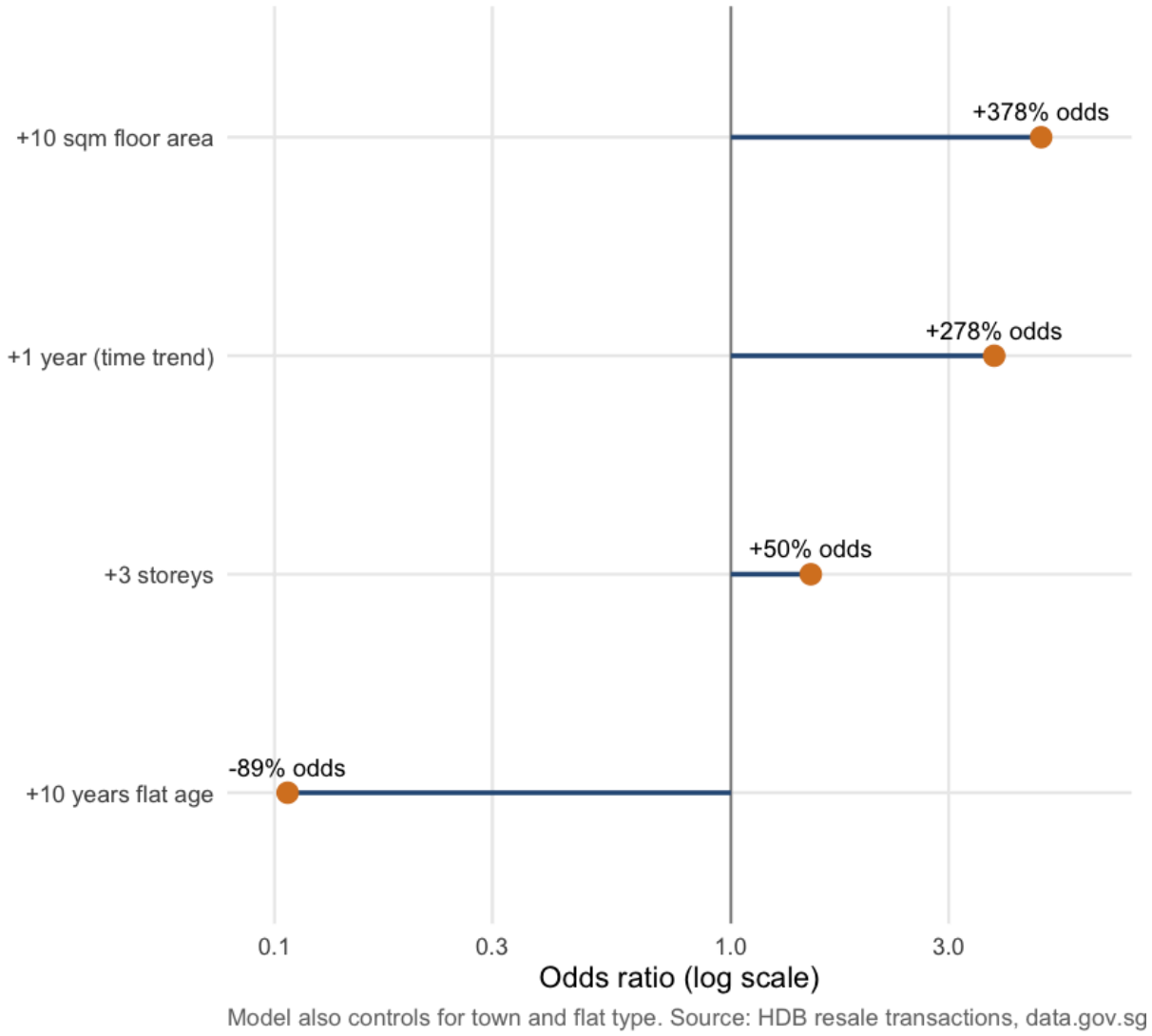
Sources: EdgeProp (2025); 99.co HDB Resale Flash Report (Aug 2026); HDB resale transactions (data.
The 2025 media figure covers deals to 18 Dec; ours covers the full year.

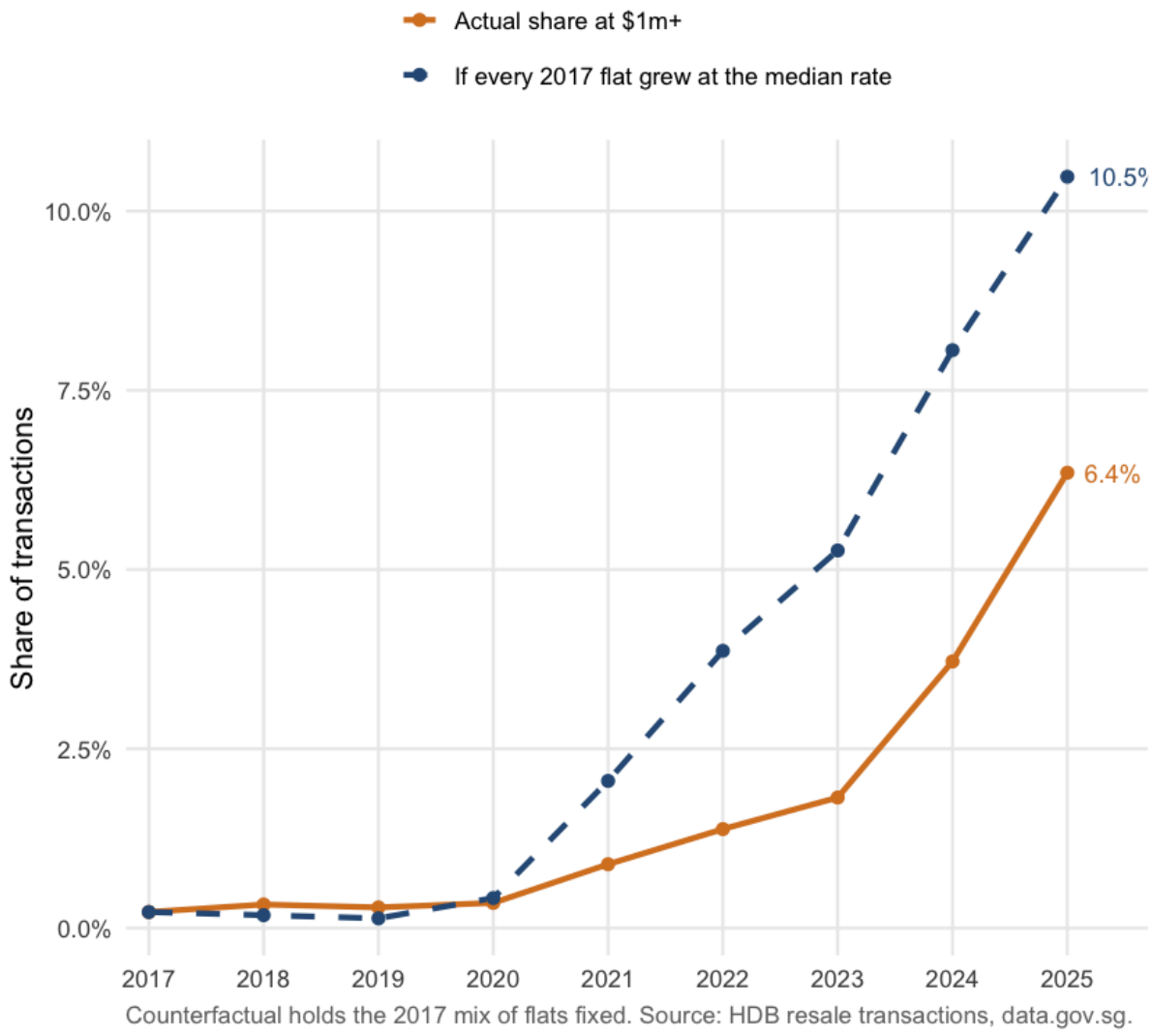

A. Median price per sqm, 4-room (S$)
1
2
3
4 5
6,000
5,000
4,000
B. Million-dollar deals per month
150
100
50
0
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
2026
Sources: HDB resale transactions (data.gov.sg); policy dates from HDB/MND announcements. Descri

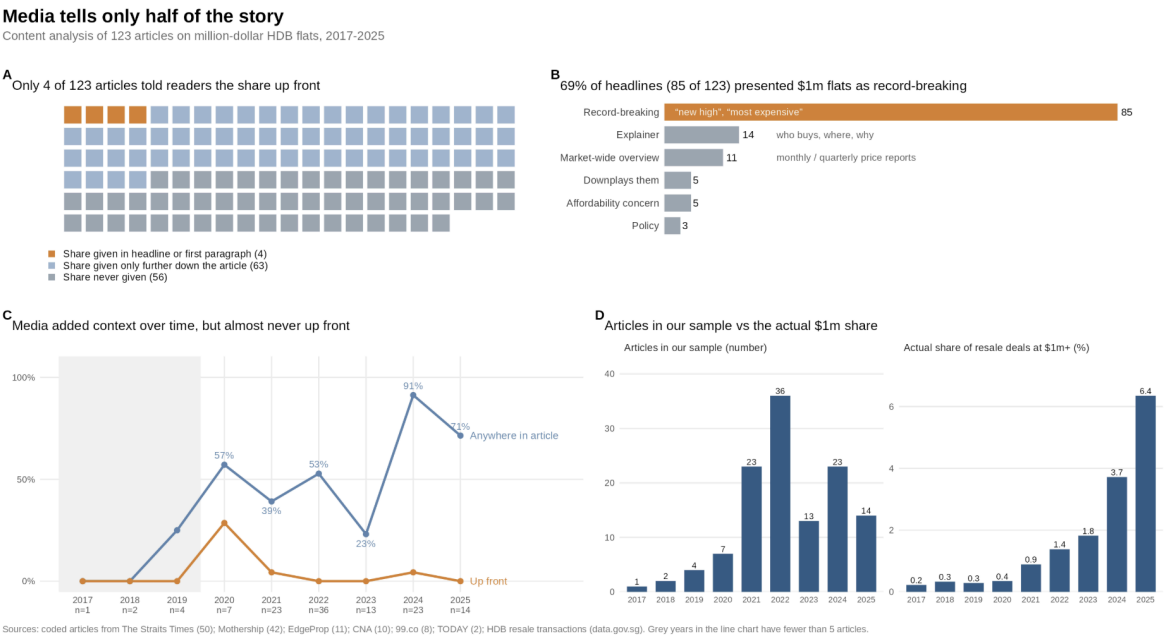

Median HDB resale price, nominal vs inflation-adjusted (2025 dollars)
Nominal (dollars of each year)
Real (2025 dollars)
Median resale price
$600k
$500k
$400k
$628k
$486k
$410k
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
Sources: HDB resale transactions (data.gov.sg); SingStat CPI, all items (2024 = 100).


A $1m flat
Typical 4-room flat
Typical resale flat (all types)
Years of household income
10.0
7.5
5.0
2.5
0.0
9.2
7.4
3.8
4.4
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
Sources: HDB resale transactions (data.gov.sg); SingStat Key Household Income Trends 2017-202
2025 excluded: SingStat changed the income definition in 2025.


Other towns
Top-5 $1m towns (E4)
SEMBAWANG
WOODLANDS
PASIR RIS
SENGKANG
CHOA CHU KANG
PUNGGOL
BUKIT PANJANG
HOUGANG
SERANGOON
YISHUN
JURONG WEST
TAMPINES
BUKIT BATOK
BEDOK
GEYLANG
BISHAN
TOA PAYOH
ANG MO KIO
KALLANG/WHAMPOA
JURONG EAST
BUKIT TIMAH
CENTRAL AREA
CLEMENTI
BUKIT MERAH
QUEENSTOWN
MARINE PARADE
0%
20%
40%
60%
Estimated price change, 2017-2025
Model: log(price) ~ year x town + flat type + floor area + flat age + storey. Dashed line = n


+10 sqm floor area
+378% odds
+1 year (time trend)
+278% odds
+3 storeys
+50% odds
+10 years flat age
-89% odds
0.1
0.3
1.0
3.0
Odds ratio (log scale)
Model also controls for town and flat type. Source: HDB resale transactions, data.gov.sg


Actual share at $1m+
If every 2017 flat grew at the median rate
Share of transactions
10.0%
7.5%
5.0%
2.5%
0.0%
10.5%
6.4%
2017
2018
2019
2020
2021
2022
2023
2024
2025
Counterfactual holds the 2017 mix of flats fixed. Source: HDB resale transactions, data.gov.sg.


Media tells only half of the story
Content analysis of 123 articles on million-dollar HDB flats, 2017-2025
A
Only 4 of 123 articles told readers the share up front
Share given in headline or first paragraph (4)
Share given only further down the article (63)
Share never given (56)
B
69% of headlines (85 of 123) presented $1m flats as record-breaking
Record-breaking
"new high", "most expensive"
85
Explainer
14
who buys, where, why
Market-wide overview
11
monthly / quarterly price reports
Downplays them
5
Affordability concern
5
Policy
3
C
Media added context over time, but almost never up front
100%
50%
0%
57%
39%
53%
23%
91%
71%
Anywhere in article
Up front
2017 n=1
2018 n=2
2019 n=4
2020 n=7
2021 n=23
2022 n=36
2023 n=13
2024 n=23
2025 n=14
D
Articles in our sample vs the actual $1m share
Articles in our sample (number)
Actual share of resale deals at $1m+ (%)
Sources: coded articles from The Straits Times (50); Mothership (42); EdgeProp (11); CNA (10); 99.co (8); TODAY (2); HDB resale transactions (data.gov.sg). Grey years in the line chart have fewer than 5 articles.